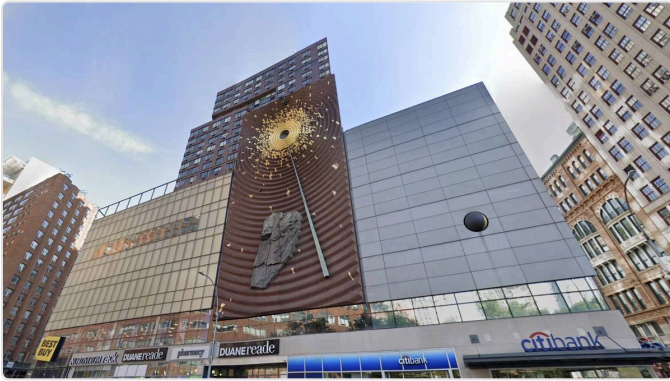
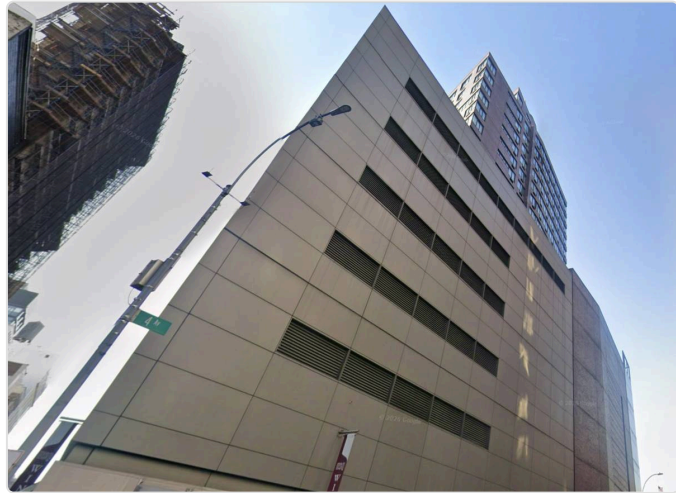


THE BUILDING TODAY



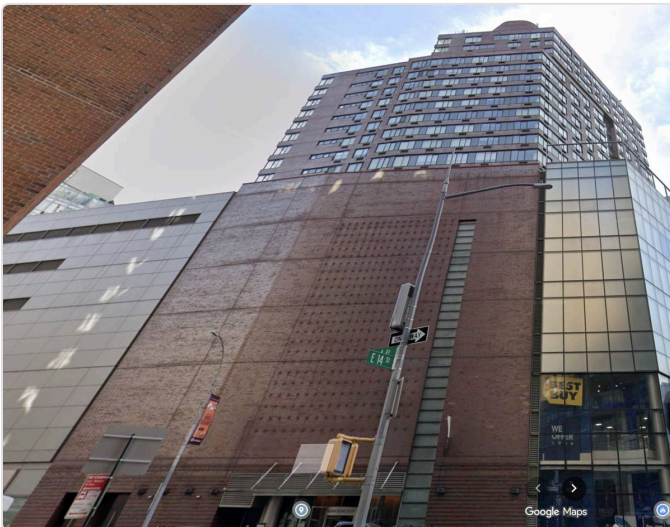
The Metronome facade

From 14th Street, looking south-east.



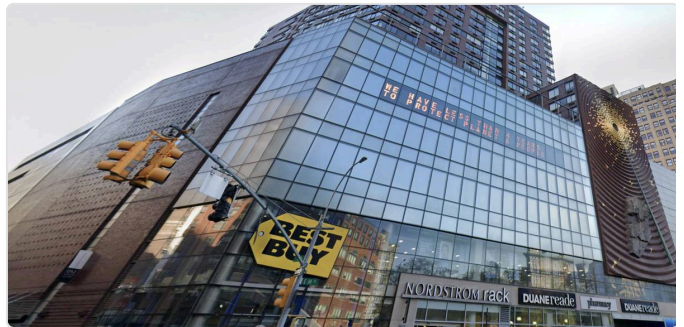
Fourth Avenue elevation

The panelled south end of the block, near East 13th Street.



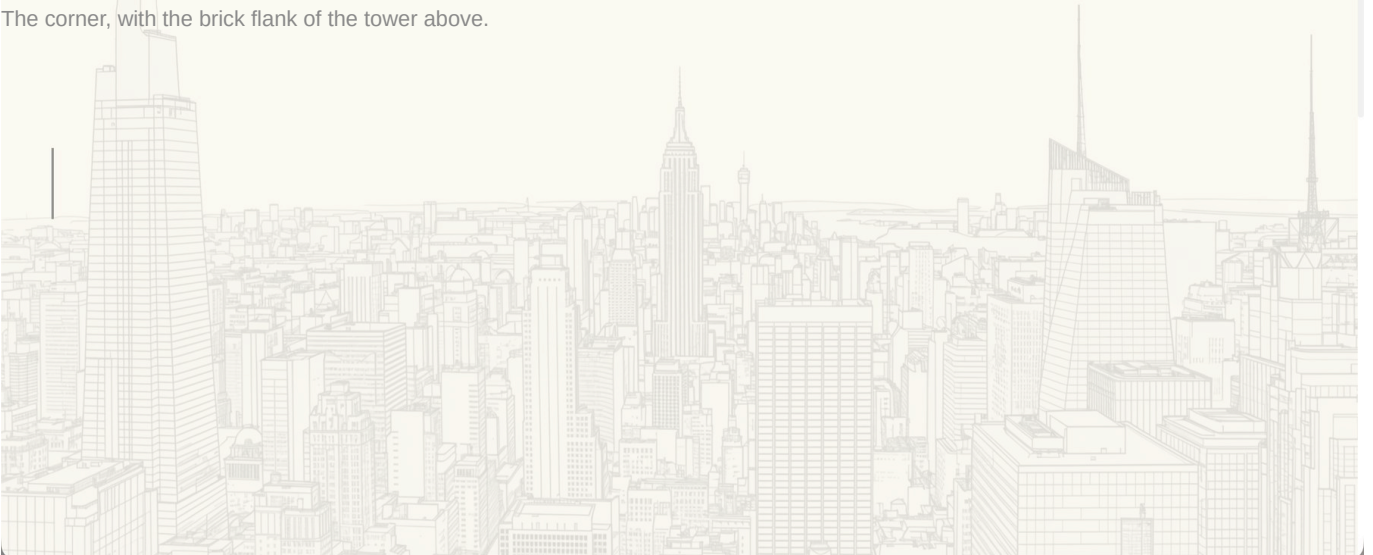
Fourth Avenue at 14th Street

The corner, with the brick flank of the tower above.



14th Street frontage

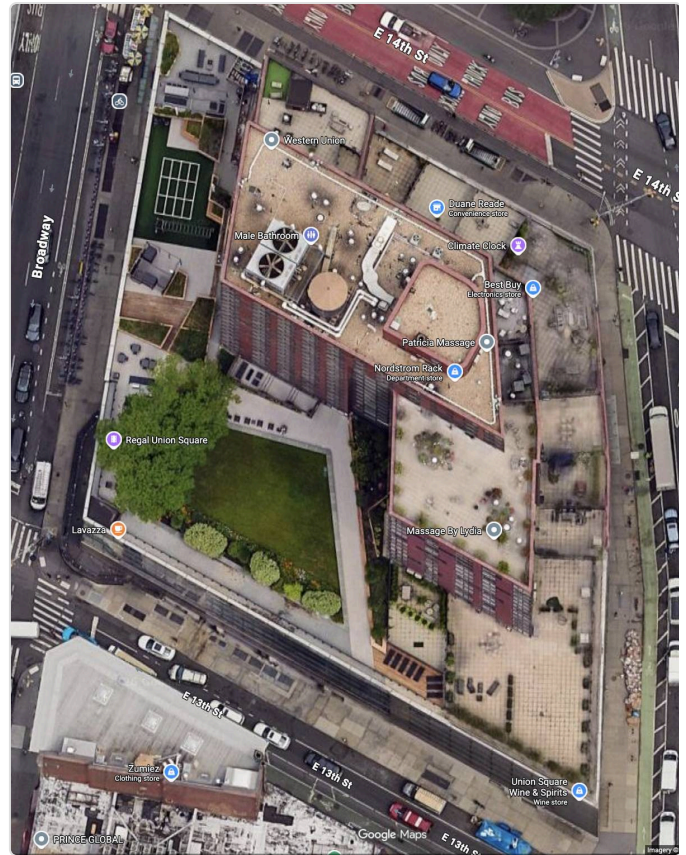
Retail base, Climate Clock, and the edge of *Metronome*.





Broadway at 13th Street

The Regal cinema entrance on the Broadway corner.

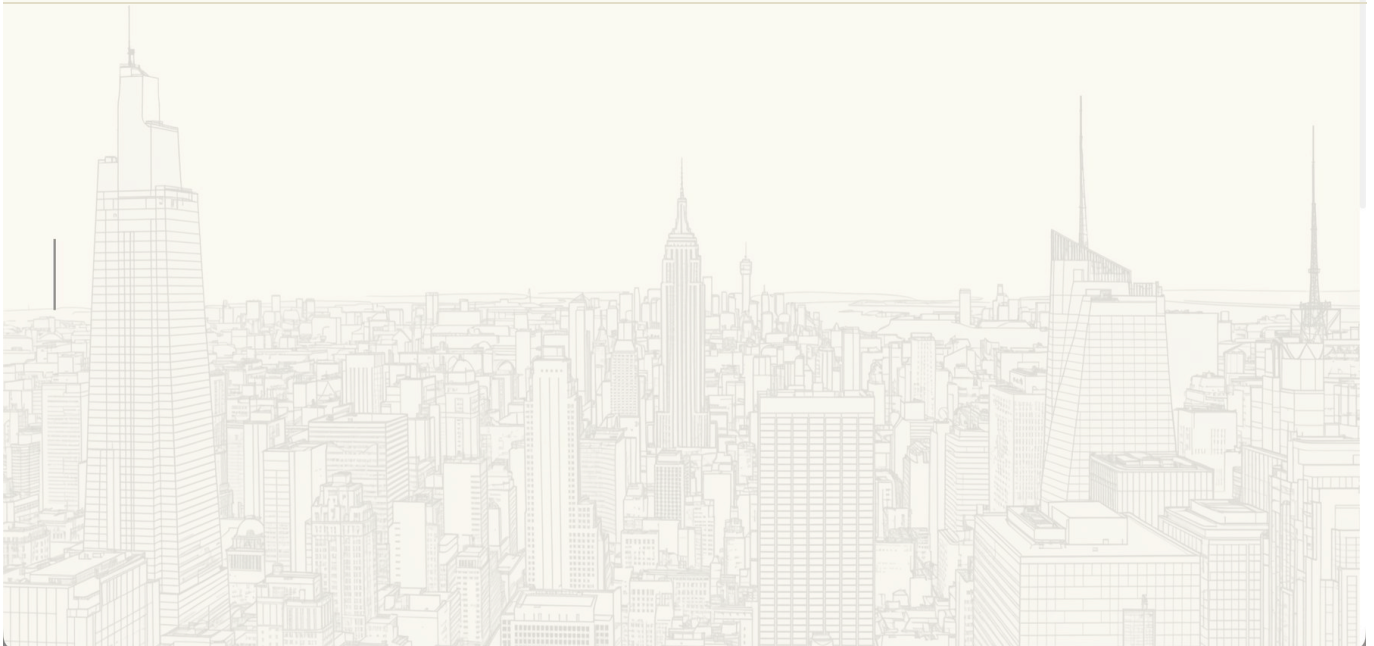


The block from above

Broadway to Fourth Avenue, 13th to 14th Street.

842 Broadway

Every previously italicized phrase is highlighted and colour-coded by source. Where the source page is on file, clicking the highlight opens the scan.



COLOUR KEY — ONE COLOUR PER SOURCE · sources with a page scan are marked ♪

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| ■ Harris, <i>One Thousand New York Buildings</i> , 2002 (8) ♪ | ■ Stern, <i>New York 2000, 2006</i> (26) ♪ |
| ■ Egan, <i>Pop Culture New York City</i> , 2018 (2) ♪ | ■ Unknown Author, <i>Oasis Map</i> (1) |
| ■ Zimmer, <i>Art Hiding in New York</i> , 2020 (12) ♪ | ■ AIA, <i>Union Square</i> , 1999 (9) ♪ |
| ■ Leffel & Lehman, <i>The Best Things to Do in New York</i> , 2016 (3) ♪ | ■ Helmreich, <i>The Manhattan Nobody Knows</i> , 2018 (2) ♪ |
| ■ Perris, <i>1853 Perris Maps</i> (1) ♪ | ■ Dripps, <i>1867 Dripps Plan</i> (1) ♪ |
| ■ Robinson, <i>1885 Robinsons Atlas</i> (1) ♪ | ■ Bromley, <i>1897 Bromleys Atlas</i> (1) ♪ |
| ■ G. W. Bromley & Co., <i>1916 Atlas of the Borough of Manhattan</i> (2) ♪ | ■ Bromley, <i>1930 Land Book of the Borough of Manhattan</i> (2) ♪ |
| ■ Bromley, <i>1955 Manhattan Land Book</i> (1) ♪ | ■ Miller, <i>Greenwich Village and how it got that way</i> , 1990 (5) ♪ |
| ■ Morris, <i>Incredible New York</i> , 1951 (3) ♪ | ■ Howe, <i>New York Shopping Guide for 1895</i> (1) |
| ■ Stern, <i>New York 1880, 1999</i> (10) ♪ | ■ Morgan, <i>The Civil War Lover's Guide to New York City</i> , 2013 (1) ♪ |
| ■ Gabrielan, <i>Along Broadway</i> , 2007 (2) ♪ | ■ Stokes, <i>The Iconography of Manhattan Island Volume Three</i> , 1918 (2) ♪ |
| ■ Jenkins, <i>The Greatest Street in the World</i> , 1911 (1) ♪ | ■ Stokes, <i>The Iconography of Manhattan Island Volume Five</i> , 1926 (2) |
| ■ Dunlap, <i>On Broadway</i> , 1990 (4) ♪ | |

AUDIO — 842 BROADWAY | 30% TRANSITIONAL TEXT 26 min 02 s

Audio track — playable in the HTML version of this document.

The Present Structure: 842 Broadway, Union Square South (1998)

The present structure occupies a site long counted among the most conspicuous in Manhattan. It is situated on (14th Street between Fourth Avenue and Broadway), referenced in shorthand as (Union Square South (1998)), with its site given more precisely as (58-60 East 14th Street between Broadway and 4th Avenue, Union Square). The record is unambiguous on its age: (Was built in 1998.) This is echoed throughout the sources, which describe it as (Union Square South (1998)) and mark the moment (When Union Square South opened late in 1998.) Its celebrated public art followed close behind, for it was (Installed in 1999) and is formally dated as (Kristin Jones and Andrew Ginzel, *Metronome*, 1996-99, One Union Square South.)

It was (designed by Davis, Brody & Associates in association with Schuman, Lichtenstein, Claman & Efron), recorded elsewhere as (1999, Davis Brody Bond and Schuman Lichtenstein Claman & Efron.) The guiding vision ran along family lines, for (Davis, Brody's winning scheme, designed by Steven Davis, son of founding partner Lewis Davis, sought to merge the base with the tower.) The entertainment quarters were (designed by associate architects Schuman, Lichtenstein, Claman & Efron.) Direction came from a prominent developer, for the site was acquired by (the Related Companies) in 1995, and (the developer Stephen M. Ross went through over two hundred submissions before he chose the perplexing *Metronome*.)

Seen in the round, it is *(a twenty-seven-story, 180-unit apartment building atop an eighty-five-foot-high mixed-use retail base that included a fourteen-screen theater.)* Its footprint *(occupied the highly visible 47,500-square-foot full-block site bounded by Fourth Avenue, Thirteenth Street, Broadway, and Fourteenth Street.)* Accounts of capacity vary, with one noting *(There are also 240 apartments here)*, and the building contained *(fourteen theaters in this building)* along with *(the Virgin Megastore here)* — a small city folded within a single block.

The structure declares its aesthetic allegiances in precise vocabulary. Its *(Architecture Style_Postmodern.)* The palette is rendered with clinical exactness: the *(Base Color_Crystal - 213 213 213)*, and the *(Façade Color_Sonic Silver - 166 166 166.)* Its walls are of *(Base Material_Granite Bulkheads, Limestone, Aluminum, Glass)*, and *(Façade Material_Composite Panels.)* The *(Entrance Description_Storefront, Recessed)*, and the *(Window Detail_Storefront.)* Crowning it, the *(Brickwork Style_Public Artwork: "Metronome"-Concentric Brick Circles, Bedrock)*, while the *(Roofline Description_Flat, Parapet.)*

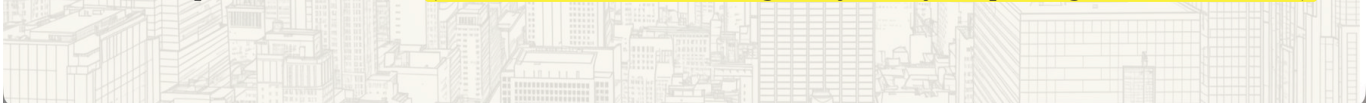
The great artwork is the building's most arresting feature. The *(Artwall, Kristin Jones and Andre and Andrew Genzel)*, is listed formally as *(Metronome, Kristen Jones and Andrew Ginzel (1999).)* The artists *(had been chosen to embellish a 100-by-60-foot wall on the building's north facade, between the commercial base and the tower.)* Its scale is extraordinary, for *(The central component, measuring one hundred feet high and sixty feet wide, has an undulating brick wall with a dark circular void, surrounded by gold leaf overlay that dissipates across the panel into gold fragments.)* In the artists' own language, *(Jones and Ginzel proposed 'Metronome', confronting the street with a brick wall overlaid with an undulating wavelike pattern of concentric circles and a so-called eye, a four-foot-in-diameter opening that emitted clouds of steam.)* That steam carried deliberate meaning, for *(The steam, intended by the artists to recall the geothermal outpouring of Old Faithful, poured forward twice a day, at noon and at midnight, as part of the artists' intention to examine time itself.)* Nor was it silent, since *(Each emission was enhanced by the sounding of a long, tapered horn intended to echo the passage of time.)* Adding a temporal dimension, *(A digital clock on the left side of the wall augmented the frequent movements of the city by simultaneously counting and subtracting the hours of the day, with the converging digits in the middle absorbed by a blur of activity, intended to suggest the present.)* Complementing this, *(Below, a massive rock juts out through the brick wall, and to the left on the glass facade is a digital timepiece that counts the twenty-four hours of the day while simultaneously subtracting the time remaining in the day.)* Balancing it, *(To the right is the lunar timepiece, composed of a sphere set into a socket, which is synchronized to revolve with the phases of the moon.)* Yet time has worn its machinery, for *(then there is the steam, which used to puff out over 14th Street several times a day, but hasn't worked in several years.)* The ambition was immense and costly, since *(it's also one of the largest private commissions for public art in history)*, and *(the three-million-dollar piece is meant to symbolize the intangibility of time.)* That figure looms large, for *(Though the theater was cheap, 'Metronome', at \$3 million, was not.)* Its spirit was celebratory, as *(The complicated piece is an homage to the vibrant energy that is New York City.)* For the patient passerby it *(tells the time to the second in fifteen brightly lit numbers. Read the numbers from left to right to see the time*

as it ticks toward midnight; read from right to left to see the time count down to midnight.) Put another way, (It has fifteen digital numbers from left to right which count the minutes in a day and also show how much time remains in the day.)

Perhaps no observer captured its poetry more gently than the sociologist who paused beneath it: (Ahead of me, on 14th Street, I can see a large sundial and, to its left, a metronome. Sundials are the world's most ancient clocks, dating back perhaps to 3,500 BC. And the metronome is a modern-day way of measuring time. It has fifteen digital numbers from left to right which count the minutes in a day and also show how much time remains in the day. Watching the people hurrying by on this major thoroughfare, I feel that I'm looking at people in motion trying, in a way, to beat the clock while the images above chart their progress. An intriguing juxtaposition, I think.) And yet it remains an enigma to most, for (The giant wall piece that looms over the south side of Union Square is a mystery to many, with its swirled golden center, nonsensical-seeming counting numbers, and, of course, the now-ceased occasional emission of steam.)

It is at (14TH STREET BETWEEN FOURTH AVENUE AND BROADWAY IN MANHATTAN), served by (4, 5, 6, L N, Q, R, W to 14th Street-Union Square.) Its orientation was deliberate, for the wall faces (up the length of Park Avenue South.) Indeed, (The developers entered into an agreement with the Municipal Art Society to select an architectural firm that would maximize the site's most important attributes, its axial relationship to the vista south along Park Avenue from Grand Central Terminal and its prominent location at the edge of Union Square Park.) Out of this, (Related chose three firms to participate in a competition held in 1995: Davis, Brody & Associates, Robert A. M. Stern Architects, and Hardy Holzman Pfeiffer Associates, which later withdrew.) The artwork was chosen (In a separate competition organized by the Public Art Fund.)

Ambition and reception seldom agree. (But as built, its blocky mass was pretty banal, the cut reduced to virtual inconsequence, leaving the heavy aesthetic lifting to the work of the artists Kristin Jones and Andrew Ginzel.) The theater complex (irritated Herbert Muschamp, who found it "an appalling spot with all the charm of a high security prison.") He described how (the poor moviegoer rises through a bleakly Piranesian escalator core, past sheetrock walls painted a sullen grey) only to find, (on the landings, walls adorned with what look like tubes of spangled gift-wrap.) Muschamp (castigated the building as "the worst example yet of a formula that has helped to drain the life out of New York architecture in recent years: the use of public art to cover up for uninspired buildings.") He added that (Muschamp decried both the building's bulk and 'Metronome's' scale: the "artists' basic miscalculation was to assume that a large surface called for comparably big forms.") He concluded, ("Where's the architecture? . . . The answer is: There's no architecture here. This building has no idea what it is doing here. It has nothing fresh to say, not even an eloquent silence. It's just some space in a box with a leaky hole in it.") Some deferred, noting that (Judgment on the beauty of the building's "Artwall" facade, facing up the length of Park Avenue South, is probably best left to the eye of the beholder.) And the most candid response of all is that ("What the heck is that thing?" says everyone passing Metronome, ever.)



The Physical Fabric of the Block, Traced Through the Atlases (1853–1955)

Before the present tower rose, the block was a dense accretion of brick and wood, hotel and theater and store, recorded meticulously in more than a century of atlases and land books. To read them in sequence is to watch the block thicken, rise, and modernize decade by decade.

The earliest and most granular inventory comes from the mid-nineteenth century. *(In the 1853 Perris Maps, on 842 Broadway, there is written 'New York, Livery Stable, Union Place Hotel' as well as reference to 32 Structures; Brick or Stone dwellings second class (slate or metal roof not coped) with store under, Framed dwellings with store under and skylights lighting the floor only, Brick or Stone Structure with Brick or Stone Extension, Brick or Stone dwellings second class (slate or metal roof not coped) with store under, Brick or Stone dwellings first class (slate or metal roof & coped) with skylights lighting the top floor only... Brick or Stone Framed Store first class (slate or metal roof & coped).)*

By mid-century's third decade the great theater had arrived, and the plan named the block's landmarks: *(In the 1867 Dripps Plan, on 842 Broadway, there is written 'Gibsons Building, Wallacks Theatre, Union Hotel' as well as reference to 14 Structures; Building, Building, Building...)*

By the 1880s, with Wallack's transformed into the Star, the atlas distinguished the durable from the flimsy — brick from wood: *(In the 1885 Robinsons Atlas, on 842 Broadway, there is written 'Star Theatre, Union square Theatre, Morton house' as well as reference to 18 Structures; Brick building, Brick building... Wood building, Wood building, Wood building, Wood building, Wood building...)*

At the century's close the atlas recorded the rising story-heights of the block: *(In the 1897 Bromleys Atlas, on 842 Broadway, there is written 'Star Theatre, Union Sq. Theatre, Morton Ho.' as well as reference to 25 Structures; 5 Story Brick building, 2 Story Brick building, 4 Story Brick building... 6 Story Brick building... 1 Story Brick building with Wood front, 1 Story Brick building with Wood front...)*

By the early twentieth century the block bristled with lofts, a great clothier, a hotel, a vaudeville house — and saloons: *(In the 1916 Atlas of the Borough of Manhattan, on 842 Broadway, there is written 'Lofts, Rogers Peet & Co., Hotel Churchill, Keith's Union Sq. Theatre' as well as reference to 12 Structures; 4 Story Brick Building with Store and 1 Story Brick Extension... 8 Story Brick Building with Store and Elevators and 1 Story Brick Extension, 2 Story Brick Building with Saloon, 2 Story Brick Building with Saloon, 2 Story Brick Building with Saloon, 3 Story Brick Building with Saloon, 3 Story Brick Building with Saloon and 1 Story Brick Extension.)*

By 1930 the inventory had consolidated, and the arrival of the elevator and fireproof steel construction is plainly recorded: *(In the 1930 Land Book of the Borough of Manhattan, on 842 Broadway, there is written 'Rogers Peet & Company, Acme Theatre' as well as reference to 7 Structures; Brick building, 2 Story Brick*

Building with Store, 2 Story Brick Building with Store, 2 Story Brick Building with Store, 3 Story Brick Building with Store, 3 Story Brick Building with Store and 1 Story Brick Extension, 8 Story Brick Building with Store and Elevator and Fire proof building (steel construction) and 1 Story Brick Extension.)

And the last pre-demolition inventory, at mid-century, preserved nearly the same configuration: *(In the 1955 Manhattan Land Book, on 842 Broadway, there is reference to 7 structures; 2 story brick building with stores, 6 story brick building with stores, 3 story brick building with stores and a 1 story brick extension, 3 story brick building with stores, 2 story brick building with stores, 2 story brick building with stores, 8 story brick building with stores and elevators and fireproof building (steel construction) and a 1 story brick extension.)*

The Predecessors on the Site

Wallack's Theatre / The Star Theatre

Chief among the ghosts is the playhouse that gave the corner its fame. *(If a single theater can be credited with linking Broadway with theatrical excellence, it would undoubtedly be Wallack's Theatre on the northeast corner of Broadway and Thirteenth Street. Built in 1861 as the home for Lester Wallack's stock company, it introduced true ensemble playing to New York through classical and contemporary comedies.)* Its life divided in two, for *(When Wallack's troupe moved to a new theater in 1881, the house began a second career as the Star Theatre. On its Stage appeared Sarah Bernhardt, Edwin Booth, Sir Henry Irving, Ellen Terry, and Modjeska, and it remained the city's most prestigious theater until its demolition in 1901.)*

Its origins followed fashion northward: *(At the beginning of the decade Wallack moved his company from Broadway and Broome Street, in the heart of the theatrical district, to a new and Splendid home uptown. The new Wallack's Theater was built on the northeast corner of Broadway and 13th Street, on land rented from William Backhouse Astor. It was one of the largest playhouses in the city, and in its architecture and furnishings, its handsome lobbies and lounges, represented the last word in elegance.)* Its economy of admission was carefully graded, for *(Orchestra stalls sold for one dollar; for fifty cents you could sit in the parquet, or pit; gallery gods spent only twenty-five cents for seats in the family circle. Private boxes seating seven were on sale at seven dollars, but only parvenus occupied them.)* So exclusive was its clientele that *(To play at Wallack's was the best of all passports to fame. First nights there brought out the most distinguished audience to be found in New York: the aristocracy of wealth and fashion, the leading celebrities of the stage and opera, the most beautiful 'demi-mondaines', the authors, artists and journalists of whom everyone was talking. You attended Wallack's, like the opera, as much to be seen as to see.)*

The literal plan of the house, in its Star years, is preserved: *(Star Theatre, BROADWAY and 13th STREET. / Image Caption: Stage, Box A, Orchestra, Box B, Box C, Balcony, Box D.)*

Architectural histories confirm its pedigree and afterlife: (Lester Wallack's first theater, at 485 Broadway, just south of Broome Street, opened in 1858. In 1861 he commissioned from Thomas R. Jackson a second theater, at 844 Broadway, at Thirteenth Street, and for twenty years this would be the most famous theater in the United States. By 1880, however, the theater was losing out to new uptown competitors such as the Booth, so Wallack redecorated the interior. Sensing that something more drastic was required, Wallack closed the theater in 1881 and hired George A. Freeman Jr. to design a new playhouse... The old Wallack Theater was renamed the Star and continued under other management.) It witnessed history as well as artistry, for it saw (the New York debut of actor John Wilkes Booth as Richard III. Booth came from a family of actors, but his performances from March 17 through April 5, 1862, received less-than-stellar reviews. His mediocre acting ability was always compared to that of his brother Edwin, widely considered the greatest Shakespearean actor in America.)

Its end was as historic as its heyday, for the old house (was replaced in 1902 by the present structure built by Rogers Peet & Co., the men's clothiers. Having made four decades of theatrical history, the theater made movie history in 1901 when its demolition became the subject of an early documentary film.) One later account added that (The card depicts the January 2, 1902, blaze that damaged the stores and basement but spared the theater... The Star was known as Wallick's when the area, pictured on the 13th Street block, was the theatre district.)

The Union Square Theatre

A stone's throw away stood another celebrated house, whose life was longer still. (The Union Square Theater, at 58 East Fourteenth Street, opened on September 11, 1871. It was not a new building but an alteration within the shell of what had been the Union Place Hotel, facing Union Square between Broadway and Fourth Avenue.) Like so many houses of its era, (typical of most New York theaters, it was a largely hidden asset, concealed behind the dour facade of the old hotel.) But behind that dour front lay glamour, for it was (distinguished by what the 'New York Daily Tribune' described as "a cheerful and commodious entrance. . . . The name of the new theater appears, in letters of fire, above the portal.") Inside, the Tribune noted, ("The vestibule stretches from beneath spacious porticos, and is brilliantly frescoed, in green and red, and brilliantly lighted.") Comfort was sacrificed to capacity, for (In order to pack 1,200 seats into a comparatively small area, the auditorium was built very high), so much so that the Herald's correspondent complained that from the parquet ("the decoration of the dome and even those over the proscenium are scarcely visible.") Of the artistry itself the Herald was faintly damning: ("Art, too, has been called in to aid in making the Union Theatre a fit temple for the muses. We cannot say that the art is of a very high quality, but in view of the very low state of decorative painting in America, it is not, perhaps, fair to be over-fastidious.")

Fire struck, for (A fire in February 1888 destroyed the roof and parts of the auditorium, and the theater reopened in 1889, rebuilt to designs reputedly by Leopold Eidlitz and John E. Terhune, although some thought the design was by Charles P. Palmer, the manager of the property.) The rebuilt interior was resplendent, for

(The interior of the rebuilt theater was painted in gold and ivory and the proscenium arches contained a large medallion incorporating a painting of Shakespeare.) A terse catalogue records the whole arc of its structural life: *(Erected in centre of Union Place Hotel; opened 1871... destroyed by fire 1888... rebuilt and became Keith's Union Square Theatre 1893.)*

Its stage saw remarkable milestones. *(Here in 1876 occurred the New York stage debut of matinee idol James O'Neill, whose declining years were to be dramatized by his playwright son Eugene in 'Long Day's Journey into Night'. This theater was also the setting on August 20, 1883, of the first performance anywhere of a play by Oscar Wilde—though 'Vera, or the Nihilist', a premiere that the author attended, proved a disaster and barely finished out the week. Here George M. Cohan made his debut as a solo performer, soon after the Union Square began a vaudeville policy in 1893.)* In time the moving image supplanted the actor, for *(Two years later the Union Square became one of the earliest established theaters to project motion pictures. Initially a novelty on the vaudeville bill, motion pictures completely replaced live acts at this theater in 1908. Since 1936, the theater has been closed.)* Its fate was near-total erasure, for *(the historic Union Square Theater (1871, rebuilt, John Terhune and Leopold Eidlitz, 1889), 58 East Fourteenth Street, which had long been obscured behind a huge McDonald's sign)* was cleared to make way for the present tower.

The Union Place Hotel / Morton House / Hotel Churchill

Both theaters were, in their beginnings, entangled with a single great hostelry. *(On the southeast corner of Broadway and Fourteenth Street is the Hotel Churchill, formerly the Morton House, and originally the Union Place Hotel, established in 1850.)* Its shifting identities are traced in the record: *(The tall building in the next block east was the Union Place Hotel, leased at this time to John C. Wheeler. Sheridan Shook leased it in 1871, and called it the Maison Doree. In 1881 it became known as the Morton House. This building, as well as the one on the south-east corner of Broadway and 14th Street, was owned by Cortlandt Palmer.)* Its founding is fixed among a roster of that year's new structures, for the record notes *(the Union Place Hotel, at 860 Broadway)*, and further that *(For a history of the Union Place Hotel (known as the Morton House after 1868), at the south-east corner of Broadway and 14th St., see the N. Y. Times, Je 12, 1921.)* Its long service is summarized thus: *(Morton House, originated around 1850 as Union Place Hotel, expanded several times and was named for the Morton Brothers, operators from 1868 to the 1880s. It was demolished around 1926.)* In the end only bare ground remained, marking the *(Site of Morton House Hotel (also known as the Hotel Churchill, Union Place Hotel).)*

The Rogers Peet Building at 842 Broadway

Finally, rising upon the very ground where Wallack's had stood, came the commercial building that succeeded it. Known to many as *(Also known as the Village Voice offices)*, it is properly the *(ROGERS, PEET BUILDING, No. 842)*, and its details are these: *(1902, by Clinton & Russell. [8 stories] The red-brick facade is divided into bays topped by large segmental arches. There are copper dormers on the mansard roof. Site of*

Wallack's Theater (also known as the Germania Theater, Star), 1860-61, by Thomas R. Jackson, remodeled 1883 and 1889.) Old atlases capture the layered commerce of its heyday, recording at 842 Broadway both *('Rogers Peet & Company, Acme Theatre')* and, earlier, *('Lofts, Rogers Peet & Co., Hotel Churchill, Keith's Union Sq. Theatre.')*

Thus does a single corner hold the memory of livery stables and first-class brick dwellings, of ensemble drama and vaudeville, of grand hotels and men's clothiers, of the debut of John Wilkes Booth and the first American play of Oscar Wilde — its story written across a century of atlases in ever-rising story-heights, in the slow triumph of brick over wood and steel over brick, and now overlooked by a tower of crystal and silver, and by a great golden eye that counts, ceaselessly and to the second, the passing of the time in which all these things happened and were lost.



Citation Chart

Every highlighted quote, in order of appearance, correlated to its underlying source. The swatch matches the highlight colour in the text.

The Present Structure: 842 Broadway, Union Square South (1998)

#	Verbatim Quote (abbreviated)	Source (Author, Title, Year, Page)
1	"14th Street between Fourth Avenue and Broadway"	 Harris, <i>One Thousand New York Buildings</i> , 2002, p. 171 [page scan]
2	"Union Square South (1998)"	 Stern, <i>New York 2000</i> , 2006, p. 377 [page scan]
3	"58-60 East 14th Street between Broadway and 4th Avenue, Union Square"	 Egan, <i>Pop Culture New York City</i> , 2018, p. 168 [page scan]
4	"Was built in 1998."	 Unknown Author, <i>Oasis Map</i> , p. 1
5	"Union Square South (1998)"	 Stern, <i>New York 2000</i> , 2006, p. 377 [page scan]
6	"When Union Square South opened late in 1998."	 Stern, <i>New York 2000</i> , 2006, p. 377 [page scan]
7	"Installed in 1999"	 Zimmer, <i>Art Hiding in New York</i> , 2020, p. 219 [page scan]
8	"Kristin Jones and Andrew Ginzler, Metronome, 1996-99, One Union Square South."	 Zimmer, <i>Art Hiding in New York</i> , 2020, p. 219 [page scan]
9	"designed by Davis, Brody & Associates in association with Schuman, Lichtenstein, Claman & Efron"	 Stern, <i>New York 2000</i> , 2006, p. 377 [page scan]
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13	"the Related Companies"	 Stern, <i>New York 2000</i> , 2006, p. 377 [page scan]
14	"the developer Stephen M. Ross went through over two hundred submissions before he chose the perplexing Metronome."	 Zimmer, <i>Art Hiding in New York</i> , 2020, p. 219 [page scan]
15	"a twenty-seven-story, 180-unit apartment building atop an eighty-five-foot-high mixed-use retail base that included a fourteen-screen theater."	 Stern, <i>New York 2000</i> , 2006, p. 377 [page scan]
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20	"Architecture Style_Postmodern."	 AIA, <i>Union Square</i> , 1999, p. 1 [page scan]
21	"Base Color_Crystal - 213 213 213"	 AIA, <i>Union Square</i> , 1999, p. 1 [page scan]
22	"Façade Color_Sonic Silver - 166 166 166."	 AIA, <i>Union Square</i> , 1999, p. 1 [page scan]
23	"Base Material_Granite Bulkheads, Limestone, Aluminum, Glass"	 AIA, <i>Union Square</i> , 1999, p. 1 [page scan]
24	"Façade Material_Composite Panels."	 AIA, <i>Union Square</i> , 1999, p. 1 [page scan]
25	"Entrance Description_Storefront, Recessed"	 AIA, <i>Union Square</i> , 1999, p. 1 [page scan]
26	"Window Detail_Storefront."	 AIA, <i>Union Square</i> , 1999, p. 1 [page scan]
27	"Brickwork Style_Public Artwork: "Metronome"-Concentric Brick Circles, Bedrock"	 AIA, <i>Union Square</i> , 1999, p. 1 [page scan]
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29	"Artwall, Kristin Jones and Andre and Andrew Genzel"	 Harris, <i>One Thousand New York Buildings</i> , 2002, p. 171 [page scan]
30	"Metronome, Kristen Jones and Andrew Ginzel (1999)."	 Egan, <i>Pop Culture New York City</i> , 2018, p. 168 [page scan]
31	"had been chosen to embellish a 100-by-60-foot wall on the building's north facade, between the commercial base and the tower."	 Stern, <i>New York 2000</i> , 2006, p. 377 [page scan]
32	"The central component, measuring one hundred feet high and sixty feet wide, has an undulating brick wall with a dark circular void, surrounded by gold leaf overlay that..."	 Zimmer, <i>Art Hiding in New York</i> , 2020, p. 219 [page scan]
33	"Jones and Ginzel proposed 'Metronome', confronting the street with a brick wall overlaid with an undulating wavelike pattern of concentric circles and a so-called eye, a..."	 Stern, <i>New York 2000</i> , 2006, p. 377 [page scan]
34	"The steam, intended by the artists to recall the geothermal outpouring of Old Faithful, poured forward twice a day, at noon and at midnight, as part of the artists'..."	 Stern, <i>New York 2000</i> , 2006, p. 377 [page scan]
35	"Each emission was enhanced by the sounding of a long, tapered horn intended to echo the passage of time."	 Stern, <i>New York 2000</i> , 2006, p. 377 [page scan]
36	"A digital clock on the left side of the wall augmented the frequent movements of the city by simultaneously counting and subtracting the hours of the day, with the..."	 Stern, <i>New York 2000</i> , 2006, p. 377 [page scan]
37	"Below, a massive rock juts out through the brick wall, and to the left on the glass facade is a digital timepiece that counts the twenty-four hours of the day while..."	 Zimmer, <i>Art Hiding in New York</i> , 2020, p. 219 [page scan]

#	Verbatim Quote (abbreviated)	Source (Author, Title, Year, Page)
38	"To the right is the lunar timepiece, composed of a sphere set into a socket, which is synchronized to revolve with the phases of the moon."	 Zimmer, <i>Art Hiding in New York</i> , 2020, p. 219 [page scan]
39	"then there is the steam, which used to puff out over 14th Street several times a day, but hasn't worked in several years."	 Zimmer, <i>Art Hiding in New York</i> , 2020, p. 219 [page scan]
40	"it's also one of the largest private commissions for public art in history"	 Zimmer, <i>Art Hiding in New York</i> , 2020, p. 219 [page scan]
41	"the three-million-dollar piece is meant to symbolize the intangibility of time."	 Zimmer, <i>Art Hiding in New York</i> , 2020, p. 219 [page scan]
42	"Though the theater was cheap, 'Metronome', at \$3 million, was not."	 Stern, <i>New York 2000</i> , 2006, p. 377 [page scan]
43	"The complicated piece is an homage to the vibrant energy that is New York City."	 Zimmer, <i>Art Hiding in New York</i> , 2020, p. 219 [page scan]
44	"tells the time to the second in fifteen brightly lit numbers. Read the numbers from left to right to see the time as it ticks toward midnight; read from right to left to..."	 Leffel & Lehman, <i>The Best Things to Do in New York</i> , 2016, p. 106 [page scan]
45	"It has fifteen digital numbers from left to right which count the minutes in a day and also show how much time remains in the day."	 Helmreich, <i>The Manhattan Nobody Knows</i> , 2018, p. 189 [page scan]
46	"Ahead of me, on 14th Street, I can see a large sundial and, to its left, a metronome. Sundials are the world's most ancient clocks, dating back perhaps to 3,500 BC. And..."	 Helmreich, <i>The Manhattan Nobody Knows</i> , 2018, p. 189 [page scan]
47	"The giant wall piece that looms over the south side of Union Square is a mystery to many, with its swirled golden center, nonsensical-seeming counting numbers, and, of..."	 Zimmer, <i>Art Hiding in New York</i> , 2020, p. 219 [page scan]
48	"14TH STREET BETWEEN FOURTH AVENUE AND BROADWAY IN MANHATTAN"	 Leffel & Lehman, <i>The Best Things to Do in New York</i> , 2016, p. 106 [page scan]
49	"4, 5, 6, L N, Q, R, W to 14th Street-Union Square."	 Leffel & Lehman, <i>The Best Things to Do in New York</i> , 2016, p. 106 [page scan]
50	"up the length of Park Avenue South."	 Harris, <i>One Thousand New York Buildings</i> , 2002, p. 171 [page scan]
51	"The developers entered into an agreement with the Municipal Art Society to select an architectural firm that would maximize the site's most important attributes, its..."	 Stern, <i>New York 2000</i> , 2006, p. 377 [page scan]
52	"Related chose three firms to participate in a competition held in 1995: Davis, Brody & Associates, Robert A. M. Stern Architects, and Hardy Holzman Pfeiffer Associates,..."	 Stern, <i>New York 2000</i> , 2006, p. 377 [page scan]
53	"In a separate competition organized by the Public Art Fund."	 Stern, <i>New York 2000</i> , 2006, p. 377 [page scan]
54	"But as built, its blocky mass was pretty banal, the cut reduced to virtual inconsequence, leaving the heavy aesthetic lifting to the work of the artists Kristin Jones..."	 Stern, <i>New York 2000</i> , 2006, p. 377 [page scan]
55	"irritated Herbert Muschamp, who found it "an appalling spot with all the charm of a high security prison.""	 Stern, <i>New York 2000</i> , 2006, p. 377 [page scan]

#	Verbatim Quote (abbreviated)	Source (Author, Title, Year, Page)
56	"the poor moviegoer rises through a bleakly Piranesian escalator core, past sheetrock walls painted a sullen grey"	 Stern, <i>New York 2000</i> , 2006, p. 377 [page scan]
57	"on the landings, walls adorned with what look like tubes of spangled gift-wrap."	 Stern, <i>New York 2000</i> , 2006, p. 377 [page scan]
58	"castigated the building as "the worst example yet of a formula that has helped to drain the life out of New York architecture in recent years: the use of public art to..."	 Stern, <i>New York 2000</i> , 2006, p. 377 [page scan]
59	"Muschamp decried both the building's bulk and 'Metronome's' scale: the 'artists' basic miscalculation was to assume that a large surface called for comparably big forms.""	 Stern, <i>New York 2000</i> , 2006, p. 377 [page scan]
60	""Where's the architecture? . . . The answer is: There's no architecture here. This building has no idea what it is doing here. It has nothing fresh to say, not even an..."	 Stern, <i>New York 2000</i> , 2006, p. 377 [page scan]
61	"Judgment on the beauty of the building's "Artwall" facade, facing up the length of Park Avenue South, is probably best left to the eye of the beholder."	 Harris, <i>One Thousand New York Buildings</i> , 2002, p. 171 [page scan]
62	""What the heck is that thing?" says everyone passing Metronome, ever."	 Zimmer, <i>Art Hiding in New York</i> , 2020, p. 219 [page scan]

The Physical Fabric of the Block, Traced Through the Atlases (1853–1955)

#	Verbatim Quote (abbreviated)	Source (Author, Title, Year, Page)
63	"In the 1853 Perris Maps, on 842 Broadway, there is written 'New York, Livery Stable, Union Place Hotel' as well as reference to 32 Structures; Brick or Stone dwellings..."	 Perris, <i>1853 Perris Maps</i> , p. 65 [page scan]
64	"In the 1867 Dripps Plan, on 842 Broadway, there is written 'Gibsons Building, Wallacks Theatre, Union Hotel' as well as reference to 14 Structures; Building, Building,..."	 Dripps, <i>1867 Dripps Plan</i> , p. 7 [page scan]
65	"In the 1885 Robinsons Atlas, on 842 Broadway, there is written 'Star Theatre, Union square Theatre, Morton house' as well as reference to 18 Structures; Brick building,..."	 Robinson, <i>1885 Robinsons Atlas</i> , p. 12 [page scan]
66	"In the 1897 Bromleys Atlas, on 842 Broadway, there is written 'Star Theatre, Union Sq. Theatre, Morton Ho.' as well as reference to 25 Structures; 5 Story Brick..."	 Bromley, <i>1897 Bromleys Atlas</i> , p. 16 [page scan]
67	"In the 1916 Atlas of the Borough of Manhattan, on 842 Broadway, there is written 'Lofts, Rogers Peet & Co., Hotel Churchill, Keith's Union Sq. Theatre' as well as..."	 G. W. Bromley & Co., <i>1916 Atlas of the Borough of Manhattan</i> , p. 41 [page scan]
68	"In the 1930 Land Book of the Borough of Manhattan, on 842 Broadway, there is written 'Rogers Peet & Company, Acme Theatre' as well as reference to 7 Structures; Brick..."	 Bromley, <i>1930 Land Book of the Borough of Manhattan</i> , p. 40 [page scan]
69	"In the 1955 Manhattan Land Book, on 842 Broadway, there is reference to 7 structures; 2 story brick building with stores, 6 story brick building with stores, 3 story..."	 Bromley, <i>1955 Manhattan Land Book</i> , p. 30 [page scan]

Wallack's Theatre / The Star Theatre

#	Verbatim Quote (abbreviated)	Source (Author, Title, Year, Page)
70	"If a single theater can be credited with linking Broadway with theatrical excellence, it would undoubtedly be Wallack's Theatre on the northeast corner of Broadway and..."	Miller, <i>Greenwich Village and how it got that way</i> , 1990, p. 104 [page scan]
71	"When Wallack's troupe moved to a new theater in 1881, the house began a second career as the Star Theatre. On its Stage appeared Sarah Bernhardt, Edwin Booth, Sir Henry..."	Miller, <i>Greenwich Village and how it got that way</i> , 1990, p. 104 [page scan]
72	"At the beginning of the decade Wallack moved his company from Broadway and Broome Street, in the heart of the theatrical district, to a new and Splendid home uptown. The..."	Morris, <i>Incredible New York</i> , 1951, p. 65 [page scan]
73	"Orchestra stalls sold for one dollar; for fifty cents you could sit in the parquet, or pit; gallery gods spent only twenty-five cents for seats in the family circle..."	Morris, <i>Incredible New York</i> , 1951, p. 65 [page scan]
74	"To play at Wallack's was the best of all passports to fame. First nights there brought out the most distinguished audience to be found in New York: the aristocracy of..."	Morris, <i>Incredible New York</i> , 1951, p. 65 [page scan]
75	"Star Theatre, BROADWAY and 13th STREET. / Image Caption: Stage, Box A, Orchestra, Box B, Box C, Balcony, Box D."	Howe, <i>New York Shopping Guide for 1895</i> , p. 33
76	"Lester Wallack's first theater, at 485 Broadway, just south of Broome Street, opened in 1858. In 1861 he commissioned from Thomas R. Jackson a second theater, at 844..."	Stern, <i>New York 1880</i> , 1999, p. 670 [page scan]
77	"the New York debut of actor John Wilkes Booth as Richard III. Booth came from a family of actors, but his performances from March 17 through April 5, 1862, received..."	Morgan, <i>The Civil War Lover's Guide to New York City</i> , 2013, p. 65 [page scan]
78	"was replaced in 1902 by the present structure built by Rogers Peet & Co., the men's clothiers. Having made four decades of theatrical history, the theater made movie..."	Miller, <i>Greenwich Village and how it got that way</i> , 1990, p. 104 [page scan]
79	"The card depicts the January 2, 1902, blaze that damaged the stores and basement but spared the theater... The Star was known as Wallick's when the area, pictured on the..."	Gabrielan, <i>Along Broadway</i> , 2007, p. 56 [page scan]

The Union Square Theatre

#	Verbatim Quote (abbreviated)	Source (Author, Title, Year, Page)
80	"The Union Square Theater, at 58 East Fourteenth Street, opened on September 11, 1871. It was not a new building but an alteration within the shell of what had been the..."	Stern, <i>New York 1880</i> , 1999, p. 665
81	"typical of most New York theaters, it was a largely hidden asset, concealed behind the dour facade of the old hotel."	Stern, <i>New York 1880</i> , 1999, p. 665
82	"distinguished by what the 'New York Daily Tribune' described as 'a cheerful and commodious entrance. . . . The name of the new theater appears, in letters of fire, above..."	Stern, <i>New York 1880</i> , 1999, p. 665

#	Verbatim Quote (abbreviated)	Source (Author, Title, Year, Page)
83	““The vestibule stretches from beneath spacious porticos, and is brilliantly frescoed, in green and red, and brilliantly lighted.””	 Stern, <i>New York 1880</i> , 1999, p. 665
84	“In order to pack 1,200 seats into a comparatively small area, the auditorium was built very high”	 Stern, <i>New York 1880</i> , 1999, p. 665
85	““the decoration of the dome and even those over the proscenium are scarcely visible.””	 Stern, <i>New York 1880</i> , 1999, p. 665
86	““Art, too, has been called in to aid in making the Union Theatre a fit temple for the muses. We cannot say that the art is of a very high quality, but in view of the...”	 Stern, <i>New York 1880</i> , 1999, p. 665
87	“A fire in February 1888 destroyed the roof and parts of the auditorium, and the theater reopened in 1889, rebuilt to designs reputedly by Leopold Eidlitz and John E....”	 Stern, <i>New York 1880</i> , 1999, p. 665
88	“The interior of the rebuilt theater was painted in gold and ivory and the proscenium arches contained a large medallion incorporating a painting of Shakespeare.”	 Stern, <i>New York 1880</i> , 1999, p. 665
89	“Erected in centre of Union Place Hotel; opened 1871... destroyed by fire 1888... rebuilt and became Keith's Union Square Theatre 1893.”	 Stokes, <i>The Iconography of Manhattan Island Volume Three</i> , 1918, p. 986
90	“Here in 1876 occurred the New York stage debut of matinee idol James O'Neill, whose declining years were to be dramatized by his playwright son Eugene in 'Long Day's...'”	 Miller, <i>Greenwich Village and how it got that way</i> , 1990, p. 110
91	“Two years later the Union Square became one of the earliest established theaters to project motion pictures. Initially a novelty on the vaudeville bill, motion pictures...”	 Miller, <i>Greenwich Village and how it got that way</i> , 1990, p. 110
92	“the historic Union Square Theater (1871, rebuilt, John Terhune and Leopold Eidlitz, 1889), 58 East Fourteenth Street, which had long been obscured behind a huge...”	 Stern, <i>New York 2000</i> , 2006, p. 377 [page scan]

The Union Place Hotel / Morton House / Hotel Churchill

#	Verbatim Quote (abbreviated)	Source (Author, Title, Year, Page)
93	“On the southeast corner of Broadway and Fourteenth Street is the Hotel Churchill, formerly the Morton House, and originally the Union Place Hotel, established in 1850.”	 Jenkins, <i>The Greatest Street in the World</i> , 1911, p. 222 [page scan]
94	“The tall building in the next block east was the Union Place Hotel, leased at this time to John C. Wheeler. Sheridan Shook leased it in 1871, and called it the Maison...”	 Stokes, <i>The Iconography of Manhattan Island Volume Three</i> , 1918, p. 704 [page scan]
95	“the Union Place Hotel, at 860 Broadway”	 Stokes, <i>The Iconography of Manhattan Island Volume Five</i> , 1926, p. 1825
96	“For a history of the Union Place Hotel (known as the Morton House after 1868), at the south-east corner of Broadway and 14th St., see the N. Y. Times, Je 12, 1921.”	 Stokes, <i>The Iconography of Manhattan Island Volume Five</i> , 1926, p. 1825
97	“Morton House, originated around 1850 as Union Place Hotel, expanded several times and was named for the Morton Brothers, operators from 1868 to the 1880s. It was...”	 Gabrielan, <i>Along Broadway</i> , 2007, p. 56 [page scan]

#	Verbatim Quote (abbreviated)	Source (Author, Title, Year, Page)
98	"Site of Morton House Hotel (also known as the Hotel Churchill, Union Place Hotel)."	 Dunlap, On Broadway, 1990, p. 108 [page scan]

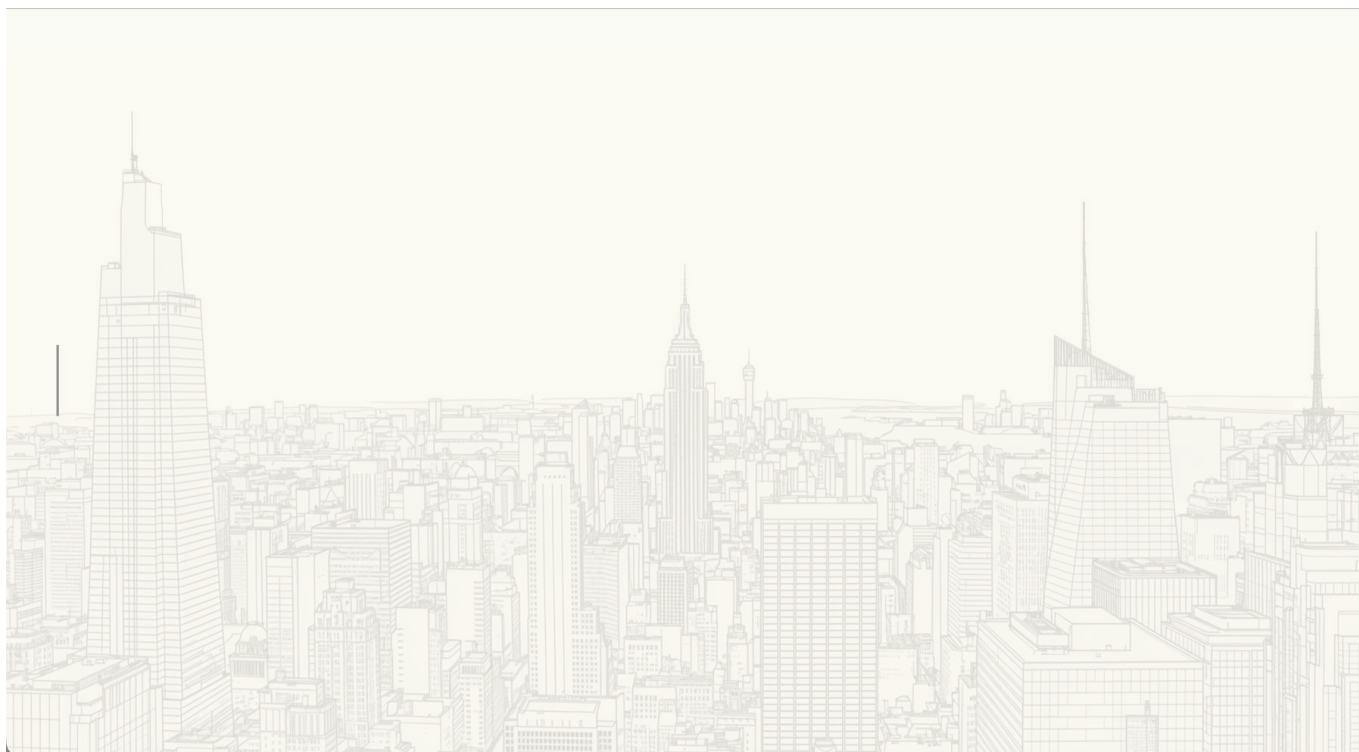
The Rogers Peet Building at 842 Broadway

#	Verbatim Quote (abbreviated)	Source (Author, Title, Year, Page)
99	"(Also known as the Village Voice offices)"	 Dunlap, On Broadway, 1990, p. 108 [page scan]
100	"ROGERS, PEET BUILDING, No. 842"	 Dunlap, On Broadway, 1990, p. 108 [page scan]
101	"1902, by Clinton & Russell. [8 stories] The red-brick facade is divided into bays topped by large segmental arches. There are copper dormers on the mansard roof. Site of..."	 Dunlap, On Broadway, 1990, p. 108 [page scan]
102	"Rogers Peet & Company, Acme Theatre"	 Bromley, 1930 <i>Land Book of the Borough of Manhattan</i> , p. 40 [page scan]
103	"Lofts, Rogers Peet & Co., Hotel Churchill, Keith's Union Sq. Theatre."	 G. W. Bromley & Co., 1916 <i>Atlas of the Borough of Manhattan</i> , p. 41 [page scan]



Source Pages

22 scanned pages, one per cited source page. Each lists the highlighted quotes drawn from it.



Harris, *One Thousand New York Buildings*, 2002, p. 171

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STUYVESANT TOWN

EAST 14TH STREET TO EAST 20TH STREET
FIRST AVENUE TO AVENUE C

1947, IRWIN CLAWAN AND GILMORE CLARKE

The Metropolitan Life Insurance Company replaced eighteen blocks of slums with these thirty-five middle-income high-rise buildings creating a suburb in the city for returning World War II veterans. Rents originally averaged \$76.50 a month for the 8,755 apartments, but have since risen with inflation to about \$1,000. In 2001, it was announced that rents for new vacancies in the now destabilized units would go up to between \$2,100 and \$4,200 a month.



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280

ONE UNION SQUARE SOUTH

14TH STREET BETWEEN FOURTH AVENUE AND BROADWAY

1999, DAVIS BRODY BOND AND
SCHUMAN LICHTENSTEIN CLAMAN & EFRON
ARTWALL, KRISTIN JONES AND
ANDRE AND ANDREW GINZEL

If you hear something you like in a movie at one of the fourteen theaters in this building, you might find a recording of the soundtrack at the Virgin Megastore here. There are also 240 apartments here, so some people can do all that without technically ever leaving home. Judgment on the beauty of the building's "Art-wall" façade, facing up the length of Park Avenue South, is probably best left to the eye of the beholder.



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Stern, *New York* 2000, 2006, p. 377

Quotes drawn from this page: 2 5 6 9 11 12 13 15 16 31 33 34 35 36 42 51 52 53 54 55 56 57
58 59 60 92



a move that was rigorously opposed by the Union Square Community Coalition, a group largely made up of newer residents who had moved into lofts and apartments and feared the impact of real estate speculation on their rented homes. Efforts to rezone Zeckendorf's site coincided with a broader reassessment of the area's zoning, which had been studied in 1979–80 by Hardy Holzman Pfeiffer Associates. Those recommendations formed the basis, in 1984, of the Department of City Planning's proposed special zoning district, intended to encourage mixed-use development on underutilized sites in the park's vicinity, especially Zeckendorf's proposed one-million-square-foot project.¹⁹ Both the district and the Zeckendorf proposal for a twenty-six-story project were approved by the City Planning Commission in November 1984 and by the Board of Estimate in January 1985.²⁰ Concerns about the fate of historic buildings on other sites around the square led to the designation as landmarks of the Lincoln Building (R. H. Robertson, 1890), 1–3 Union Square West; the Bank of the Metropolis (Bruce Price, 1903), 31 Union Square West; the Century Building (William Schickel, 1881), 33 East Seventeenth Street; the Everett Building (Starrett & Van Vleck, 1908), 45 East Seventeenth Street; and the Germania Life Insurance Company Building (D'Oench & Yost, 1911), later the Guardian Life Building, 50 Union Square East.²¹

As built, the four twenty-story towers of Zeckendorf's project, unimaginatively titled *Zeckendorf Towers*, contained 670 condominium apartments rising above a seven-story base housing 320,000 square feet of offices, an atrium, a much-appreciated supermarket, theaters, and underground parking. Though banal in their detailed design, the scheme of slender, salmon-colored brick-clad towers, each topped by an open-work pyramidal crown—dismissed by the editors of the *AIA Guide* as “illuminated levitating . . . yarmulkes”—minimized shadows on the square and blockage of views from it to the tower of the Consolidated Gas Company Building (Warren & Wetmore, 1926), which they were intended to complement.²² The office floors were entered from Fourth Avenue facing Union Square Park, while the apartments were entered off Fifteenth Street. In its bland uniformity and lock-step regularity, Zeckendorf Towers was hardly inspiring, but it did help the reemerging district turn the economic corner.

While most new construction in the area involved demolition of existing buildings, a through-block parcel that had been vacant since the early 1970s permitted the construction of the twelve-story Genesis Apartments (1995) for ninety-four homeless and low-income families at 113 East Thirteenth Street and an attendant 30,000-square-foot, two-story commercial building at 114 East Fourteenth Street.²³ The project was developed by Housing Enterprise for the Less Privileged (H.E.L.P.), a nonprofit organization founded by Andrew Cuomo, son of New York State Governor Mario Cuomo. As designed by Cooper, Robertson & Partners, the quietly contextual apartment building eschewed all outward signs of social engineering in favor of an expression that many would assume was intended for a much more affluent clientele. Additionally, the building's management program included a program-services staff of fifteen to help the homeless tenants, whose stay was limited to twelve months, make an adjustment back into mainstream society. Genesis provided playgrounds, a day-care center, a basketball court, a library, and a laundry room. Although many in the community were initially opposed to the project, it proved an excellent neighbor.

The retail building on Fourteenth Street, however, was not comparable in quality; its low height, a product of zoning restrictions, contributed to its suburban strip-mall character.

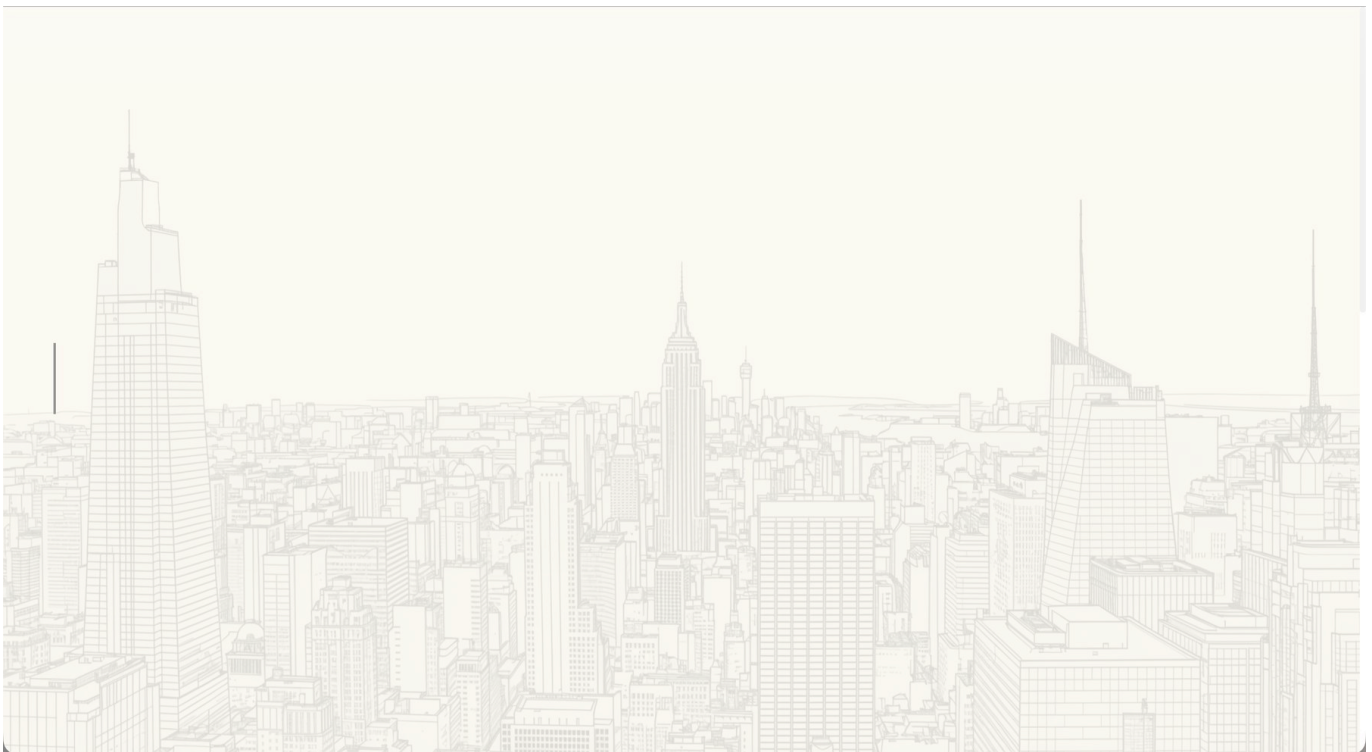
1 Union Square South (1998), designed by Davis, Brody & Associates in association with Schuman, Lichtenstein, Claman & Efron, a twenty-seven-story, 180-unit apartment building atop an eighty-five-foot-high mixed-use retail base that included a fourteen-screen theater, occupied the highly visible 47,500-square-foot full-block site bounded by Fourth Avenue, Thirteenth Street, Broadway, and Fourteenth Street.²⁴ In 1995 the Related Companies had acquired the site from another developer who had cleared it of its buildings, including the historic Union Square Theater (1871; rebuilt, John Terhune and Leopold Eidlitz, 1889), 58 East Fourteenth Street, which had long been obscured behind a huge McDonald's sign.²⁵

Responding to community concerns that this most prominent site might yield yet another business-as-usual apartment house banality, the developers entered into an agreement with the Municipal Art Society to select an architectural firm that would maximize the site's most important attributes, its axial relationship to the vista south along Park Avenue from Grand Central Terminal and its prominent location at the edge of Union Square Park. The society asked two dozen architects to name a firm, besides their own, that they would recommend for the job. From the responses, Related chose three firms to participate in a competition held in 1995: Davis, Brody & Associates, Robert A. M. Stern Architects, and Hardy Holzman Pfeiffer Associates, which later withdrew. Stern proposed an eighteen-story tower on a five-story stone-clad site-filling retail base. The metal-trimmed brick-clad tower was to be set back from the property line to create a strong south terminus for Park Avenue, recalling the campanile-like configuration of Warren & Wetmore's New York Central Building (1929), which, until the construction of the Pan Am Building in 1963, had concluded the axis of Park Avenue on the north side of Grand Central.

Davis, Brody's winning scheme, designed by Steven Davis, son of founding partner Lewis Davis, sought to merge the base with the tower. The initial rendering revealed stylish asymmetrical patterns of windows as well as a deep balcony cut into the north wall. But as built, its blocky mass was pretty banal, the cut reduced to virtual inconsequence, leaving the heavy aesthetic lifting to the work of the artists Kristin Jones and Andrew Ginzl. In a separate competition organized by the Public Art Fund, the two had been chosen to embellish a 100-by-60-foot wall on the building's north facade, between the commercial base and the tower. Jones and Ginzl proposed *Metronome*, confronting the street with a brick wall overlaid with an undulating wavelike pattern of concentric circles and a so-called eye, a four-foot-in-diameter opening that emitted clouds of steam, clearly upstaging the rather tepid facade of the host building. The steam, intended by the artists to recall the geothermal outpouring of Old Faithful, poured forward twice a day, at noon and at midnight, as part of the artists' intention to examine time itself. Each emission was enhanced by the sounding of a long, tapered horn intended to echo the passage of time. A digital clock on the left side of the wall augmented the frequent movements of the city by simultaneously counting and subtracting the hours of the day, with the converging digits in the middle absorbed by a blur of activity, intended to suggest the present.

Egan, *Pop Culture New York City*, 2018, p. 168

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Lions, Edward Clark Potter (1911): On the New York Public Library steps, 5th Avenue and 41st Street. Nicknamed "Patience" and "Fortitude." (Map 3B/Grid 3B)

Man and Dolphin Dance, Keith Haring (1987): Carmine Street swimming pool mural, Clarkson Street and 7th Avenue South (Map 2A/Grid 1C)

Memorial to Victims of the Injustices of the Holocaust, Harriet Feigenbaum (1990): New York Appellate Court Building, 27 Madison Avenue between East 25th and East 26th Streets (Map 3B/Grid 3D)

Metronome, Kristen Jones and Andrew Ginzel (1999): 58–60 East 14th Street between Broadway and 4th Avenue, Union Square (Map 2A/Grid 2A)

Mohandas Gandhi, Kantilal B. Patel (1986): Union Square West and 15th Street (Map 2A/Grid 2A)

Mother Goose, Frederick George Richard Roth (1938): Central Park, near East Drive at 72nd Street (Map 4B/Grid 3A)

Mural with Blue Brushstroke, Roy Lichtenstein (1986): AXA Equitable Center lobby, 787 7th Avenue between West 51st and 52nd Streets (Map 3A/Grid 2D)

National September 11 Memorial, Michael Arad (design) and Peter Walker + Partners (landscape) (2011): 180 Greenwich Street between Fulton Street and Liberty Street (Map 1A/Grid 2B)

New York Vietnam Veterans Memorial, Peter Wormser and William Fellows (1985): 55 Water Street near Coenties Slip (Map 1B/Grid 3C)

OY/YO sculpture, Deborah Kass (2015): Brooklyn Bridge Park, Dumbo (Map 6B/Brooklyn)

Parachute Jump, James H. Strong and Stanley Switlik (1939): Coney Island. Not in service. (Map 6B/Brooklyn)

Peace Fountain, Greg Wyatt (1984–1985): Next to the Cathedral of St. John the Divine, Amsterdam Avenue at West 111th Street (Map 5A/Grid 2B)

Pepsi-Cola Sign, Artkraft Strauss Sign Corporation (1936): Gantry Plaza State Park, Hunter's Point, Queens. (Map 6B/Queens)

Peter Pan, Charles Andrew Hafner (1928): Carl Schulz Park, East End Avenue at 86th Street. Originally created for the lobby of the Paramount Theater in Times Square. (Map 5B/Grid 4D)

Postcards, Masayuki Sono (2004): St. George Esplanade near Hamilton Avenue. The Staten Island September 11 memorial. (Map 6A/Staten Island)

Prometheus, Paul Manship (1934): The Rink at 30 Rockefeller Plaza, 5th Avenue between West 49th and West 50th Streets (Map 3A/Grid 3A)

Ralph Kramden (Jackie Gleason), Lawrence J. Nowlan, Jr. (2000): 40th Street and 8th Avenue, Port Authority Bus Terminal, south building (Map 3A/Grid 2B)
The Real World, Ted Otterness (1992): River Terrace and Warren Street (Map 1A/Grid 1A)
The Red Cube, Isamu Noguchi (1967): 140 Broadway at Liberty Street (Map 1A/Grid 2B)

Zimmer, *Art Hiding in New York*, 2020, p. 219

Quotes drawn from this page: 7 8 14 32 37 38 39 40 41 43 47 62

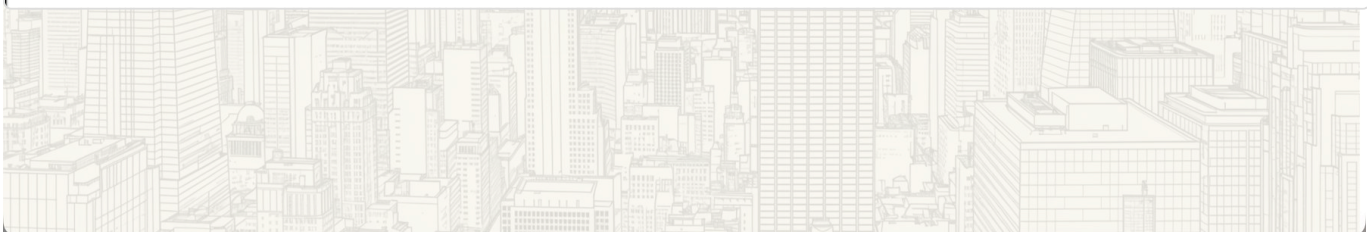


“What the heck is that thing?” says everyone passing *Metronome*, ever. The giant wall piece that looms over the south side of Union Square is a mystery to many, with its swirled golden center, nonsensical-seeming counting numbers, and, of course, the now-ceased occasional emission of steam. Aside from being a head-scratching enigma, it’s also one of the largest private commissions for public art in history. With the Public Art Fund as a consultant, the developer Stephen M. Ross went through over two hundred submissions before he chose the perplexing *Metronome*, dreamt up by Kristin Jones and Andrew Ginzel. Installed in 1999, the three-million-dollar piece is meant to symbolize the intangibility of time, a force that many New Yorkers are confronted with dozens of times in a New York minute.

The central component, measuring one hundred feet high and sixty feet wide, has an undulating brick wall with a dark circular void, surrounded by gold leaf overlay that dissipates across the panel into gold fragments. Below, a massive rock juts out through the brick wall, and to the left on the glass facade is a digital timepiece that counts the twenty-four hours of the day while simultaneously subtracting the time remaining in the day—so the seemingly nonsensical really does have logical merit after all. To the right is the lunar timepiece, composed of a sphere set into a socket, which is synchronized to revolve with the phases of the moon. And then there is the steam, which used to puff out over 14th Street several times a day, but hasn’t worked in several years.

The complicated piece is an homage to the vibrant energy that is New York City.

Kristin Jones and Andrew Ginzel, *Metronome*, 1996–99, One Union Square South

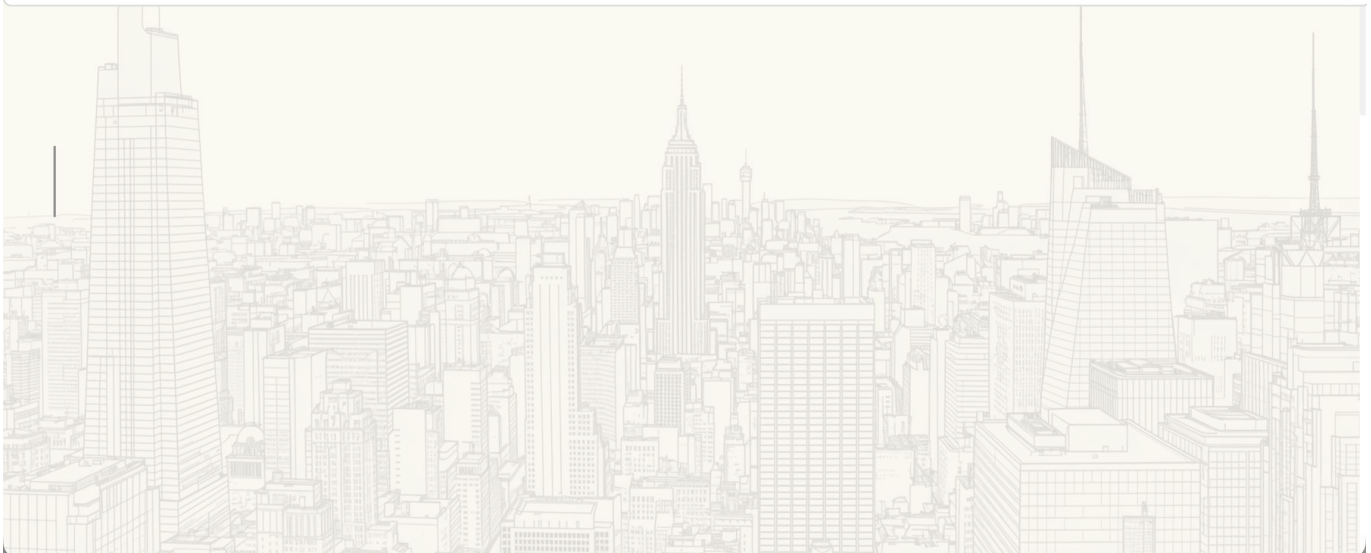


“<Architecture Style>_Postmodern, <Base Color>_Crystal
- 213 213 213, <Façade Color>_Sonic Silver - 166 166 166,
<Base Material>_Granite Bulkheads, Limestone,
Aluminum, Glass, <Façade Material>_Composite Panels,
<Entrance Description>_Storefront, Recessed, <Window
Detail>_Storefront, <Brickwork Style>_Public Artwork:
"Metronome"-Concentric Brick Circles, Bedrock,
<Roofline Description>_Flat, Parapet.”

AIA · (1999) UNION SQUARE · 1999 · P. 1

Mentioned as: "842 Broadway"

[View Document Image](#)



Leffel & Lehman, *The Best Things to Do in New York*, 2016, p. 106

Quotes drawn from this page: 44 48 49



in 1980. Almost every day you'll find devoted fans sitting around the plaque, singing Lennon songs, or leaving wreaths, cards, and flowers in his memory. If you're in New York on December 8, you can join the crowds that gather here to mark the anniversary of his assassination, which took place just yards away across Central Park West.

CENTRAL PARK BY THE 72ND STREET ENTRANCE IN MANHATTAN. *Subway: 1, 2, 3, B, C to 72nd Street.*

241. Look down on the city's biggest subway map in SoHo.

Laid into the sidewalk on Greene Street, outside the SoHo building, is Belgian artist Françoise Schein's interpretation of the city's transportation system. Created in 1986, *Subway Map Floating on a New York Sidewalk* uses stainless-steel rods for tracks and small lights for the SoHo stations and won the City Art Commission for the best piece of work that year. Stretching the length of the block between Prince and Spring Streets, the map covers only trains in Manhattan because the sidewalk width wasn't able to accommodate the other boroughs. Dulled over time and worn under-foot, it's not easy to recognize that you're walking on a map in the bustle of SoHo, but finding it will make you think of the MTA in a whole new way. 499

GREENE STREET BETWEEN PRINCE AND SPRING STREETS IN MANHATTAN. *Subway: 6 to Spring Street; B, D, F, M to Broadway-Lafayette Street.*

Time to Look at the Street

The furniture of New York streets—its benches, subway entrances, street lamps, and signposts—is as much a part of the city's character as its skyline. From the 1860s on, oversize cast-iron clocks were a ubiquitous feature of the streets, manufactured by the great clockmakers of the East Coast and often endorsed by the stores they stood in front of. But, like checkered taxicabs and "WALK/DON'T WALK" pedestrian crossing signs, over time they have been phased out, and now only a few remain. Below is a list of some of the city's remaining public timepieces, both new and old, that are worth taking the time to notice.

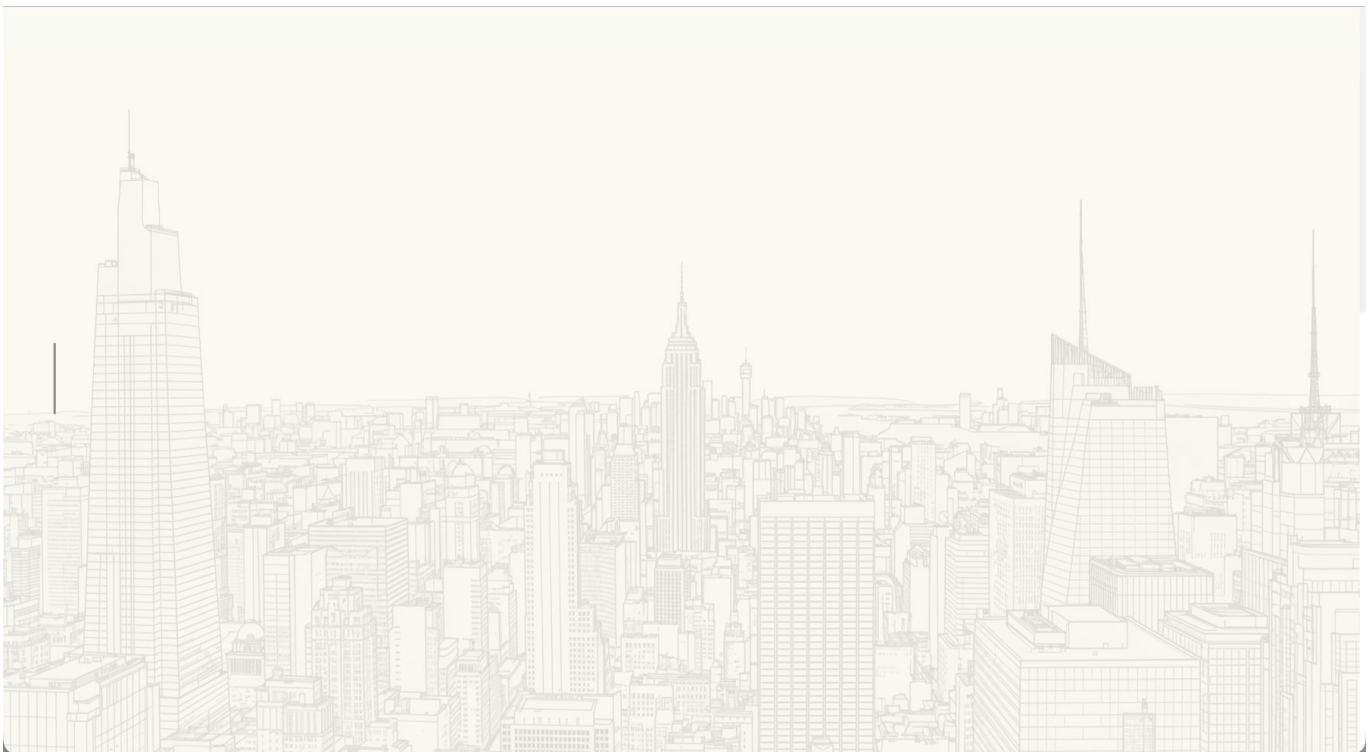
565.2

242. Metronome. High on a building wall at the south side of Union Square, this work of art by Kristin Jones tells the time to the second in fifteen brightly lit numbers. Read the numbers from left to right to see the time as it ticks toward midnight; read from right to left to see the time count down to midnight.

14TH STREET BETWEEN FOURTH AVENUE AND BROADWAY IN MANHATTAN. *Subway: 4, 5, 6, L, N, Q, R, W to 14th Street-Union Square.*

Helmreich, *The Manhattan Nobody Knows*, 2018, p. 189

Quotes drawn from this page: 45 46



along winding paths, and even birdhouses. Alas, a key is needed to enter the grounds and only those living near Gramercy Park can use it. Of course, the gardens that exist in the interior grounds of many city apartment buildings are also off-limits to the public, but they are not on the street itself, where those walking by are apt to feel particularly frustrated at being denied access to what is easily mistaken for a public park. 872.1

Leaving Gramercy Park, I turn left onto Park Avenue South and head south. At 17th Street, Park Avenue becomes Union Square East and I find myself looking upward at four huge Corinthian stone columns on my left. There aren't many of these buildings left. This one was once home to the Union Square Savings Bank. Today, it houses an off-Broadway theater. Built in 1905, it is a lonely monument to a triumphant era of American capitalism. Its massive size is a reminder that the roots of this country's admiration for materialistic success are both deep and enduring, notwithstanding the equally strong and rich history of radicalism and populism that are also a part of our nation's history and culture and its concern for the downtrodden and the unfortunate. 565.2

Ahead of me, on 14th Street, I can see a large sundial and, to its left, a metronome. Sundials are the world's most ancient clocks, dating back perhaps to 3,500 BC. And the metronome is a modern-day way of measuring time. It has fifteen digital numbers from left to right which count the minutes in a day and also show how much time remains in the day. Watching the people hurrying by on this major thoroughfare, I feel that I'm looking at people in motion trying, in a way, to beat the clock, while the images above chart their progress. An intriguing juxtaposition, I think.

Perris, 1853 *Perris Maps*, p. 65

Quotes drawn from this page: 63



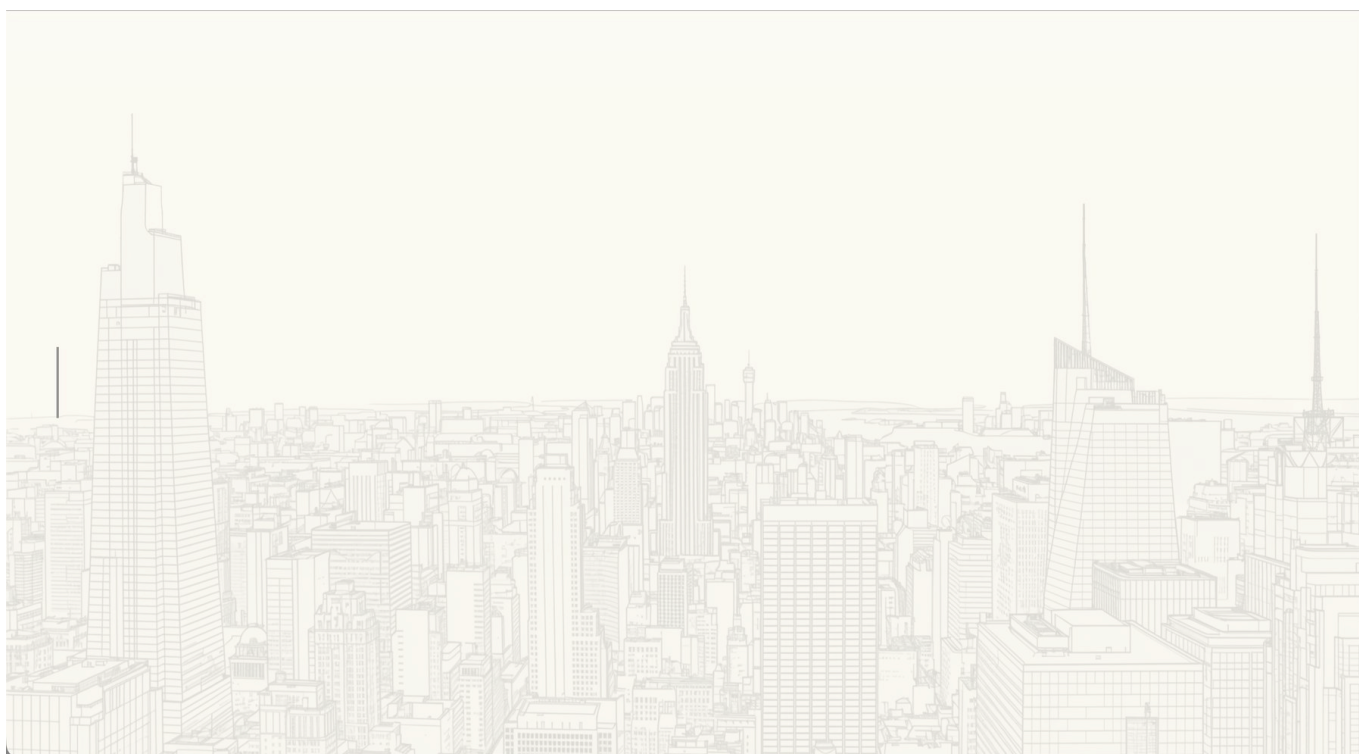


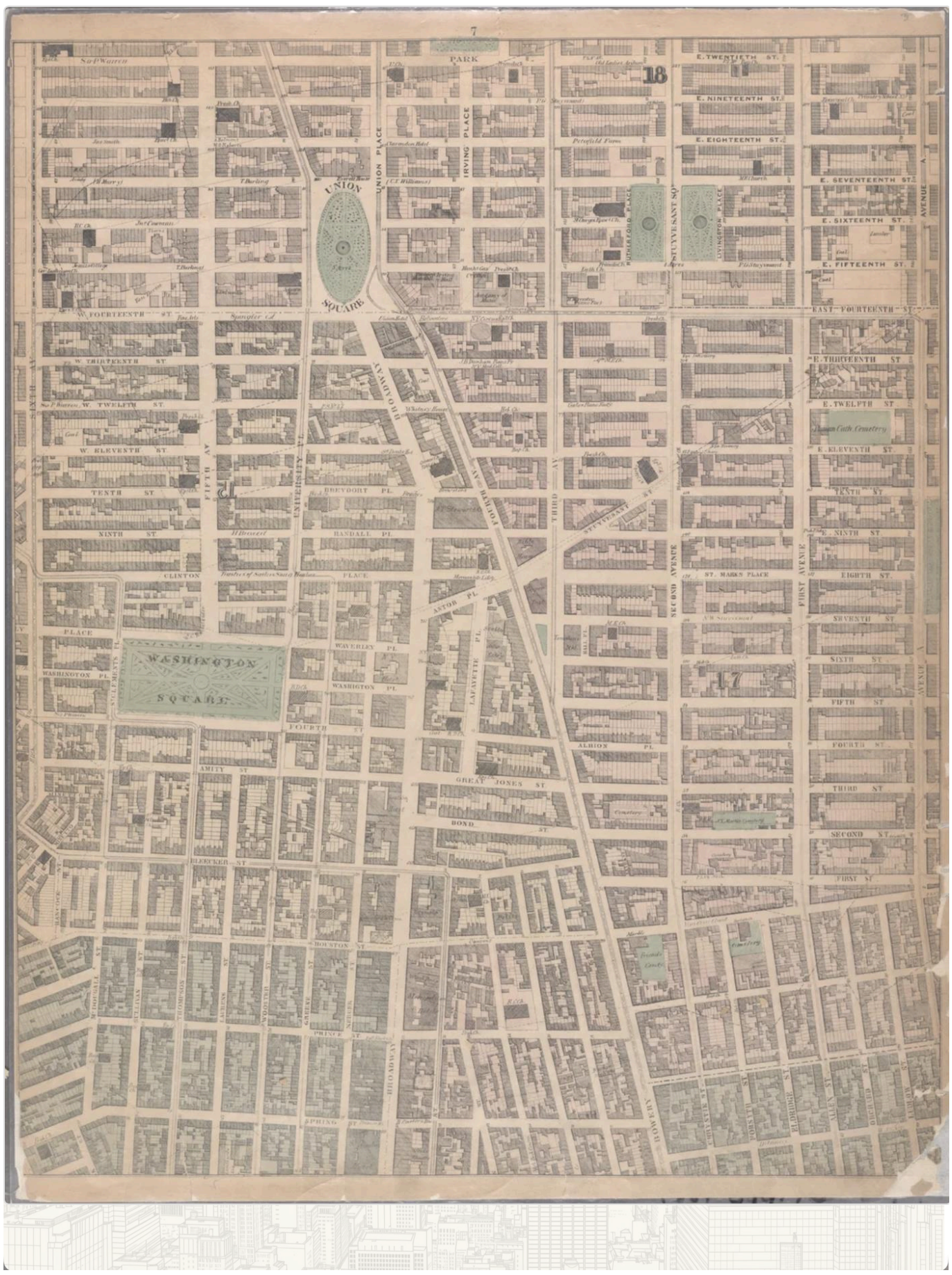
Surveyed and published by William Davis, Civil Engineer.

Litho by Knapp Brothers, N. 204 Cedar St.

Dripps, 1867 *Dripps Plan*, p. 7

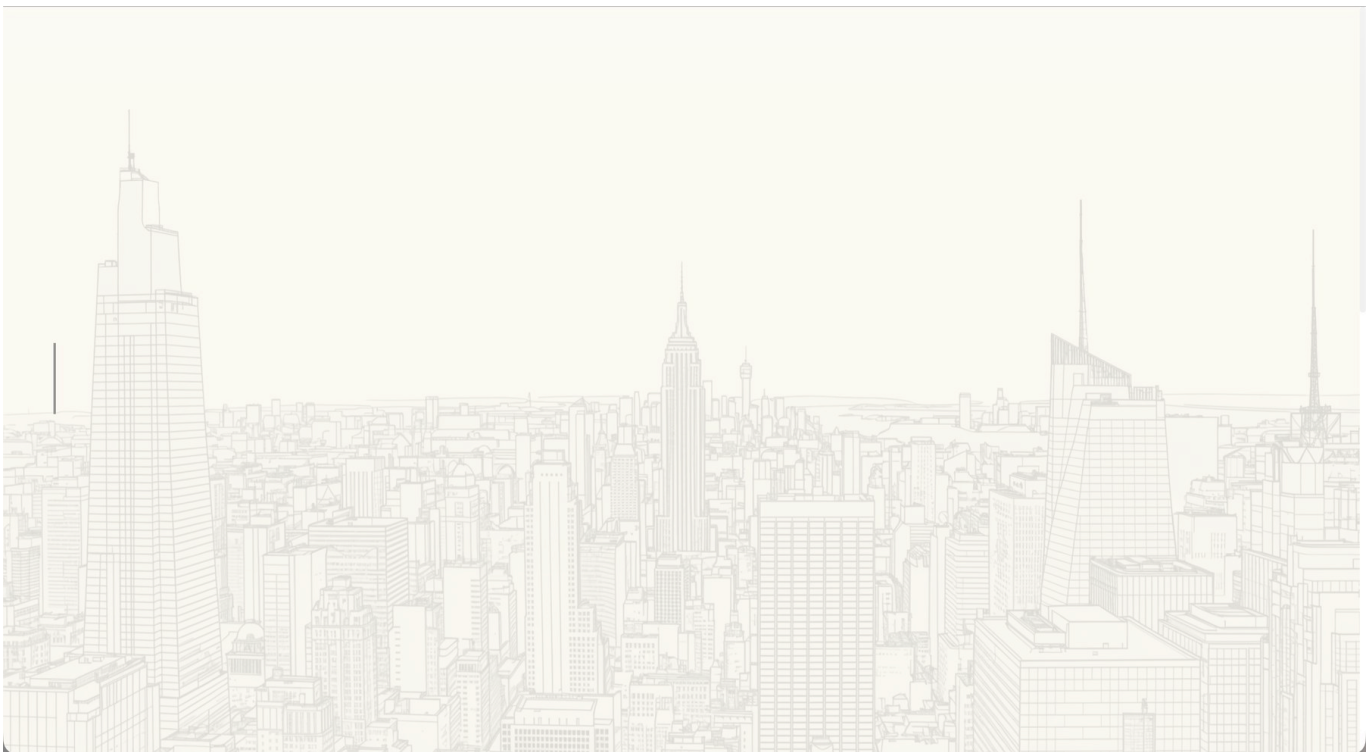
Quotes drawn from this page: 64



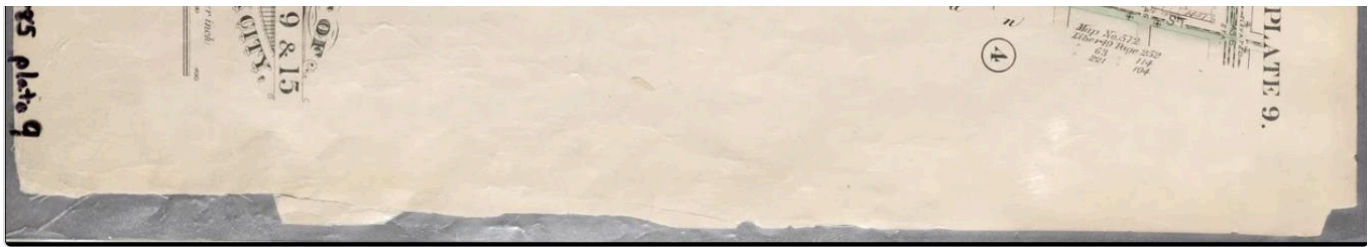


Robinson, 1885 *Robinsons Atlas*, p. 12

Quotes drawn from this page: 65

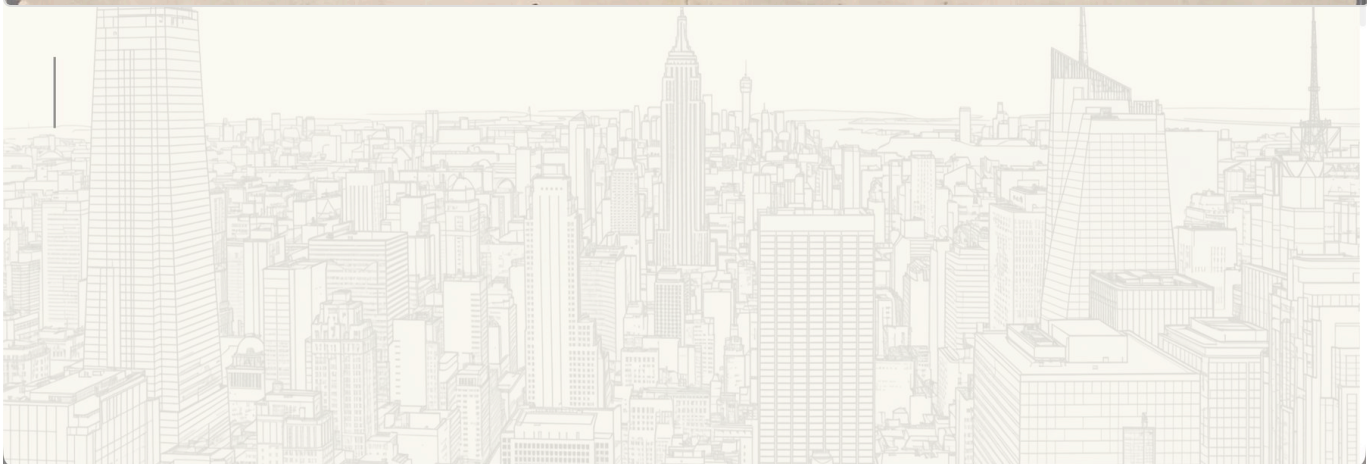
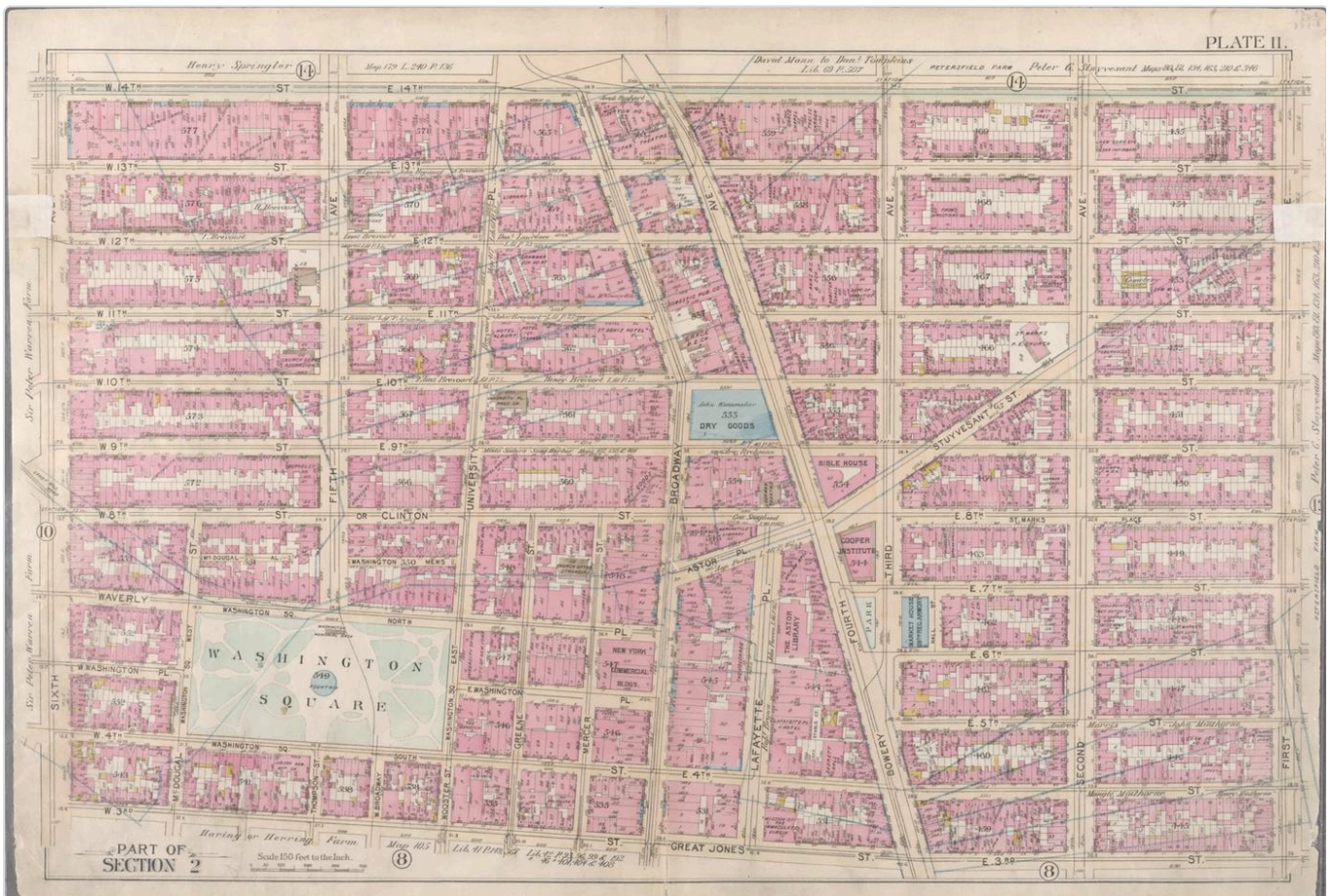






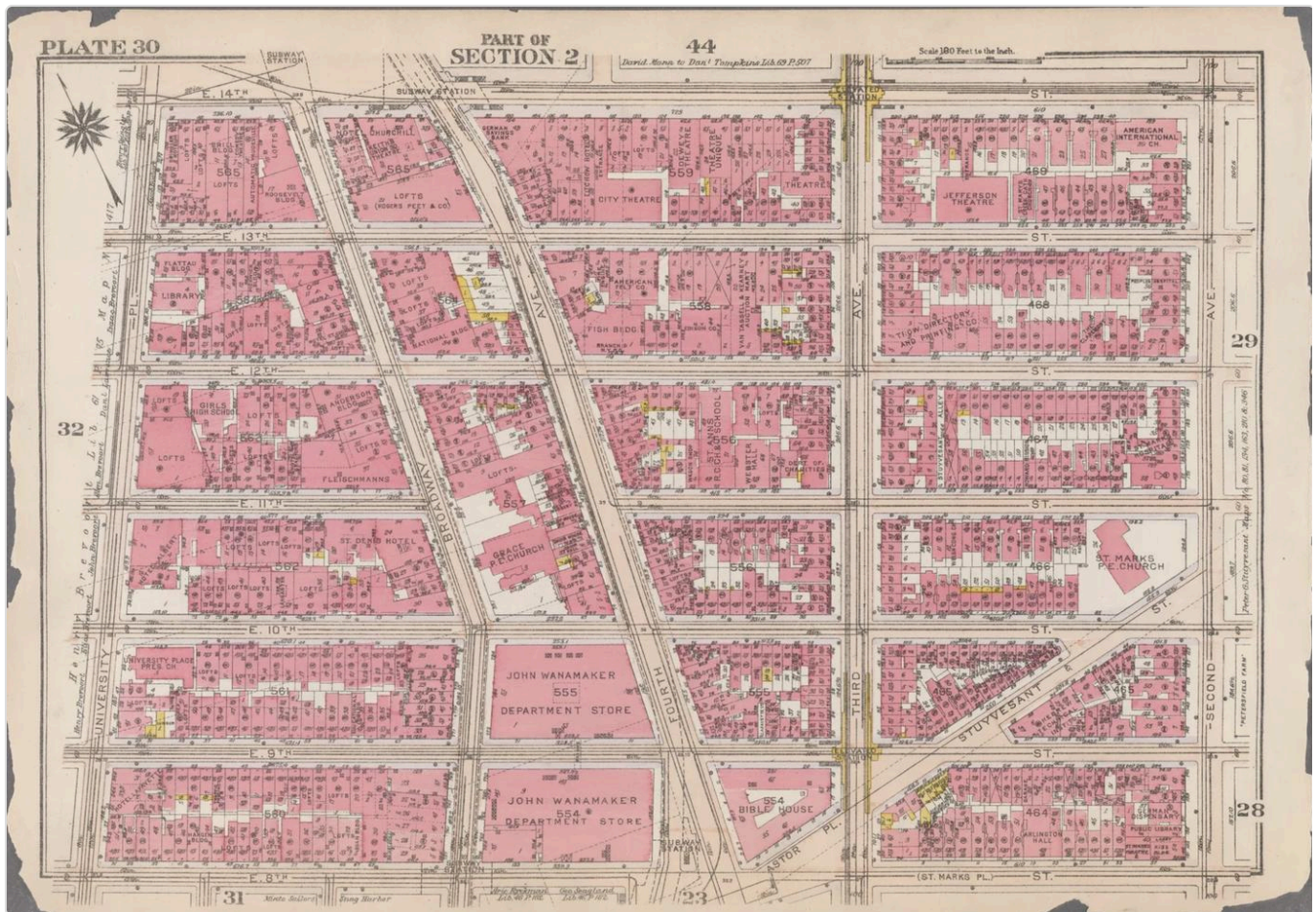
Bromley, 1897 Bromleys Atlas, p. 16

Quotes drawn from this page: 66



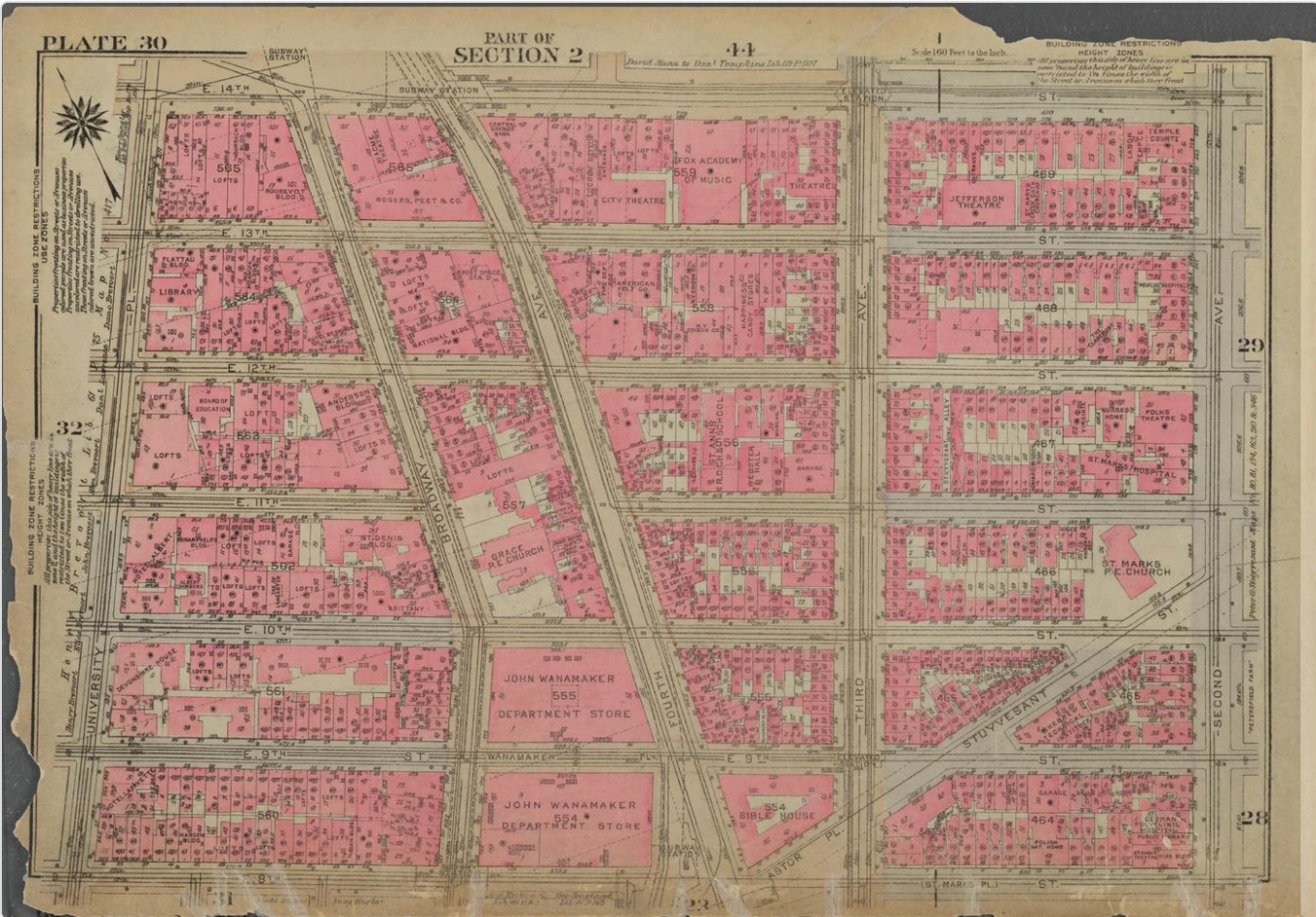
G. W. Bromley & Co., 1916 Atlas of the Borough of Manhattan, p. 41

Quotes drawn from this page: 67 103



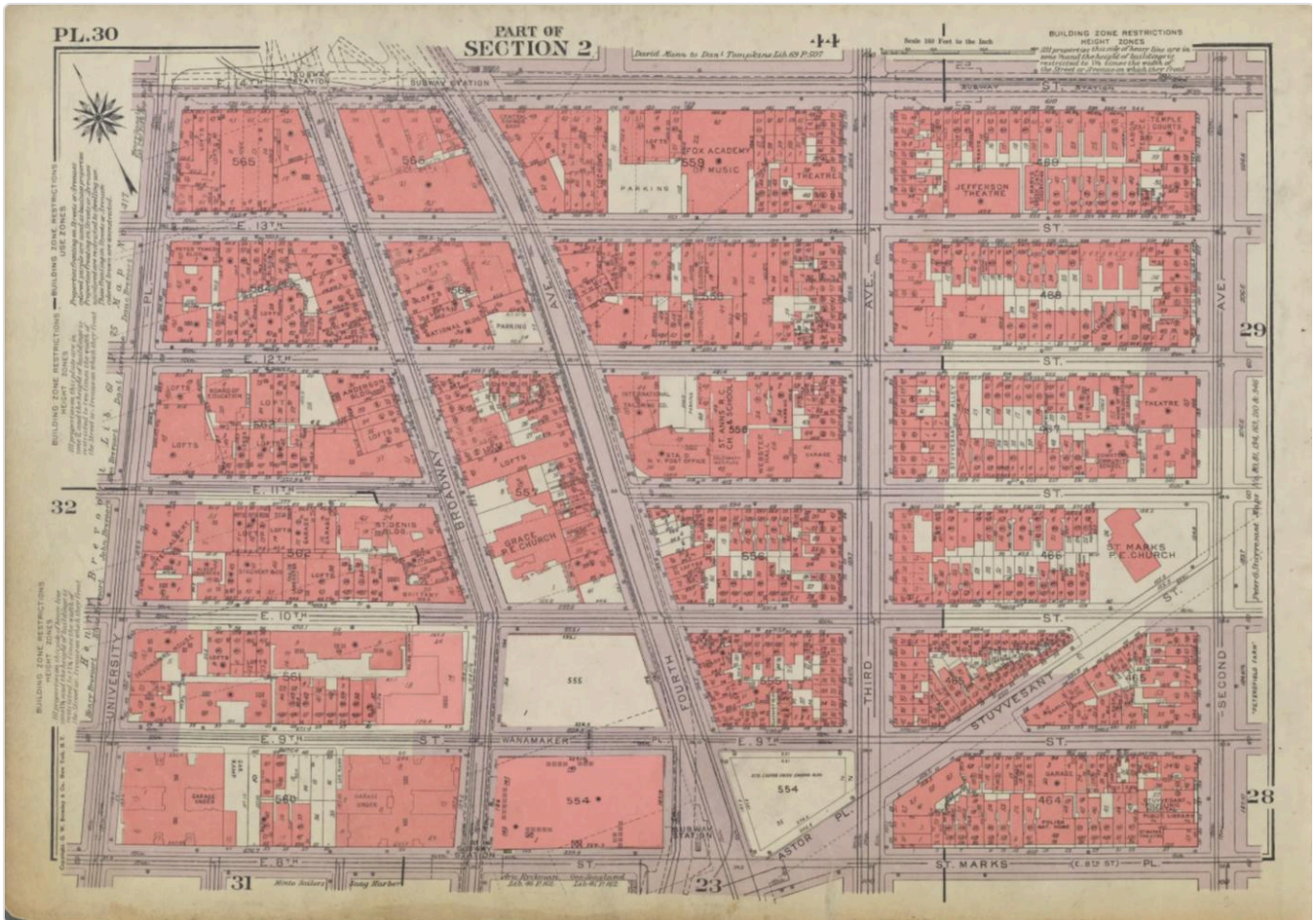
Bromley, 1930 Land Book of the Borough of Manhattan, p. 40

Quotes drawn from this page: 68 102



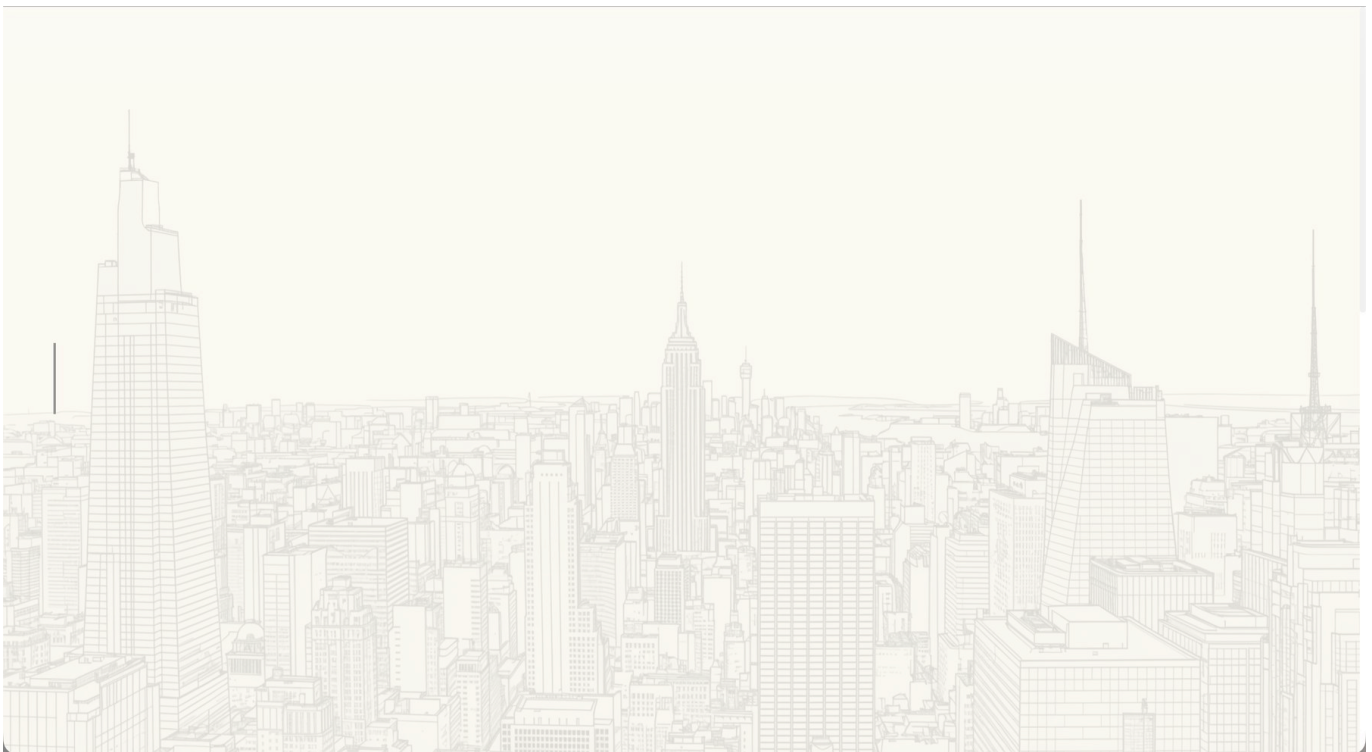
Bromley, 1955 *Manhattan Land Book*, p. 30

Quotes drawn from this page: 69



Miller, *Greenwich Village and how it got that way*, 1990, p. 104

Quotes drawn from this page: 70 71 78



Rebuilt after the 1866 fire, the Academy of Music witnessed the American premieres of several operas: *Il Trovatore*, *Semiramide*, *La Traviata*, *Aïda*, *Die Walküre*, and *Carmen*. But when its limited number of prestigious boxes proved insufficient to accommodate the city's new millionaires, they organized themselves and retaliated by opening the Metropolitan Opera House in 1883, a move that wiped opera from the Academy stage within three years. It ended its days as a movie theater in May 1926, after which it was replaced by the present 530-foot Con Edison tower.

Just east of the Academy along Fourteenth Street stood Tammany Hall, the clubhouse used by "Boss" Tweed, Jim Fisk, and their political cronies. After the fall of the Tweed Ring, theater history was made here October 24, 1881, when in its ground-floor auditorium entrepreneur Tony Pastor offered the first variety show that was refined above the level of the Houston Street concert saloons. Pastor continued to present shows here for years, offering what is now called vaudeville—a word he hated, though it's forever linked to his name. It remained the chief source of light entertainment in America for the next thirty years.

Another Greenwich Village theater saw the introduction of another theatrical institution, the cliff-hanger. In 1867 at the Worrell Sisters' Theatre, 728 Broadway at Waverly Place, a play by Augustin Daly called *Under the Gaslight* left audiences breathless. Stage effects, which Daly had seen in London two years earlier, gave the impression of a train speeding across the stage seconds after the rescue of someone who had been tied to the track. Hollywood later improved the cliff-hanger, using real trains and tying the heroine to the tracks, but in Daly's version, she was the rescuer.



Wallack's historic theater on Broadway at Thirteenth Street, under its second name, the Star. It was replaced in 1902 by the present structure built by Rogers Peet & Co., the men's clothiers. Having made four decades of theatrical history, the theater made movie history in 1901 when its demolition became the subject of an early documentary film.

Morris, *Incredible New York*, 1951, p. 65

Quotes drawn from this page: 72 73 74



Wallack's Theater as to have a box at the Academy of Music for opera or to select books from the shelves of the Society Library in University Place. Wallack's was a social institution, the city's premier theater, the nation's leading playhouse. New Yorkers returning from Paris insisted that the Wallack stock company was superior to that of the Comédie Française, and its repertory of plays far more diverting. It was the home of high comedy, not only of the classic school but of the modern, for the brilliant actor-manager Lester Wallack introduced to New York, with the plays of T. W. Robertson—*Society, Ours, Progress, Caste, Home*—a kind of natural, elegant, play of contemporary life previously unknown to American audiences.

At the beginning of the decade Wallack moved his company from Broadway and Broome Street, in the heart of the theatrical district, to a new and splendid home uptown. The new Wallack's Theater was built on the north-east corner of Broadway and Thirteenth Street, on land rented from William Backhouse Astor. It was one of the largest playhouses in the city, and in its architecture and furnishings, its handsome lobbies and lounges, represented the last word in elegance. Orchestra stalls sold for one dollar; for fifty cents you could sit in the parquet, or pit; gallery gods spent only twenty-five cents for seats in the family circle. Private boxes seating seven were on sale at seven dollars, but only parvenus occupied them. According to the inscrutable tradition of New York, to take a box for the play was even more flagrantly bad form than not to take one for the opera. The actresses and actors of Wallack's company ranked high among the city's reigning favorites. Yet Lester Wallack received only one hundred and twenty-five dollars a week. Mrs. John Hoey, the highly talented leading lady, received one hundred. Mary Gannon, whom playgoers regarded as the most beautiful and perfect of all ingénues, was paid forty dollars weekly. To play at Wallack's was the best of all passports to fame. First nights there brought out the most distinguished audience to be found in New York: the aristocracy of wealth and fashion, the leading celebrities of the stage and opera, the most beautiful *demi-mondaines*, the authors, artists and journalists of whom everyone was talking. You attended Wallack's, like the opera, as much to be seen as to see.

Old-fashioned playgoers sometimes complained that the stage was falling on evil days. They were loyal to ageing Edwin Forrest, whom the irreverent younger generation contemptuously described as "a ranter." When the veteran tragedienne, Charlotte Cushman, returned to New York after a long absence in Europe, they welcomed her with enthusiasm. Miss Cushman revived, among other plays, Shakespeare's *Henry VIII*, and on alternate evenings she assumed the roles of Queen Katharine and Cardinal Wolsey, appearing, as the Cardinal, in a full beard. Young people snickered at this whimsical performance, and were little more respectful when Miss Cushman offered a beardless but massive Romeo in what an eminent singer described as "a fine *baritone* contralto voice." But young and old playgoers alike acclaimed the Italian tragedienne Adelaide Ristori. She was no longer young, and she had never

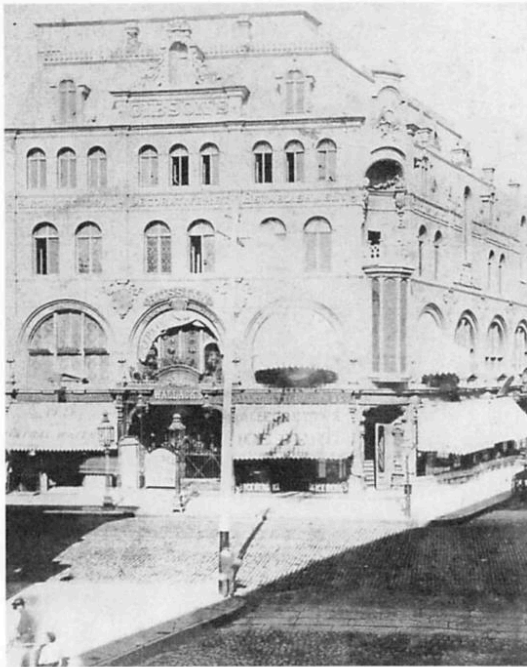
been beautiful, yet critics declared that she was “worlds in advance of any

Tear a Passion to Tatters • 65

Stern, *New York* 1880, 1999, p. 670

Quotes drawn from this page: 76





Wallack Theater, 844 Broadway. Thomas R. Jackson, 1861.
View to the east. NYHS.

control of the enterprise before the new playhouse opened on April 13, 1874. The site had 110 feet facing Broadway and a near equal amount on Twenty-second Street. To maximize real estate values, however, the decision was made to develop the Broadway frontage with a white marble-faced building to house a corner restaurant, situating the theater entrance at the least valuable, midblock location. The theater entrance led to a sixty-foot-square, nine-hundred-seat auditorium that featured what was perhaps New York's first fully sunken orchestra pit, virtually invisible from the parquet. In contrast to the marble lavished on the Broadway facade, the Twenty-second Street elevation of the auditorium was clad in Philadelphia red brick and trimmed with Nova Scotia sandstone, a design the *New York Times* found "plain and substantial rather than ornamental." That austerity carried through to the auditorium, where, as the *Times* remarked, "There is an absence of bright colors, of gorgeous upholstery, and elaborate fresco such as we are little accustomed to in our City theaters. Nothing could be more simple and, at the same time, so chaste as the design of the auditorium. The softest pink and white and gray prevail throughout."²⁵

The fame of the Park Theater peaked when, on December 18, 1875, it presented the debut of A. Oakey Hall, the former mayor, acting in a play he had also written, *The Crucible*.²⁶ Notoriety marked the theater's demise: the theater burned down late in the afternoon of October

30, 1882, the day on which Lily Langtry, the English superstar, was to have made her American debut on its stage. Langtry, a guest at the nearby Albemarle Hotel (Renwick & Auchmuty, 1860), watched the fire from a window in her suite. The Park was not rebuilt, and the site became home to C. C. Haight's Brooks Brothers Building (see below).

Josh Hart's Eagle Theater, completed in 1876 at 1287 Broadway, between Thirty-second and Thirty-third Streets, had a short but complicated history.²⁷ Hart, a prominent vaudeville manager, opened the theater on October 18, 1875, only to find that the seats were too small and too compactly arranged. Correcting these defects, he then learned that the pitch of the balconies was too slight to provide a good view of the stage, requiring a second overhaul. While nothing is known of the decoration of the theater's interior, which was destroyed by fire in 1883, the principal facade was a busy but engaging French Second Empire design, consisting of two stories and a mansard, surmounted by a soaring eagle. After the fire, the eagle was mounted on the new, six-story-high building, which housed a 1,200-seat auditorium that was, according to Moses King, "decorated in conventional style, with little attempt at artistic effect."²⁸

Lester Wallack's first theater, at 485 Broadway, just south of Broome Street, opened in 1858. In 1861 he commissioned from Thomas R. Jackson a second theater, at 844 Broadway, at Thirteenth Street, and for twenty years this would be the most famous theater in the United States. By 1880, however, the theater was losing out to new uptown competitors such as the Booth (see above), so Wallack redecorated the interior. Sensing that something more drastic was required, Wallack closed the theater in 1881 and hired George A. Freeman Jr. to design a new playhouse, to be built at 1220 Broadway, at the northeast corner of Thirtieth Street, next door to Henry Engelbert's Grand Hotel (see chapter 4).²⁹ The old Wallack Theater was renamed the Star and continued under other management.³⁰ The new Wallack Theater set an unprecedented standard for safety: it had a center aisle that tapered from six feet four inches at the entry vestibule to four feet six inches at the stage, brick fire-walls separating the auditorium from the back stage, and a glass skylight over one third of the stage that could be opened in the event of fire. Freeman carried the skylit flytower much higher than the auditorium ceiling and located the actors' dressing rooms in a separate building. The theater's lower two stories were made of rock-faced stone, while the upper stories were of imported Carlisle stone and Philadelphia brick. The auditorium contained an arcade of papier-mâché and bronze as well as sixteen mural-sized paintings illustrating the history of drama, and was surmounted by a cast-iron, gold-leafed dome. From the dome, a suspended chandelier had as its principal feature a blue porcelain ball supporting four eight-foot-high gold dragons carrying three thousand lights. The chandelier also concealed vents that allowed hot air to escape and fresh air to enter, the latter pushed

Morgan, *The Civil War Lover's Guide to New York City*, 2013, p. 65

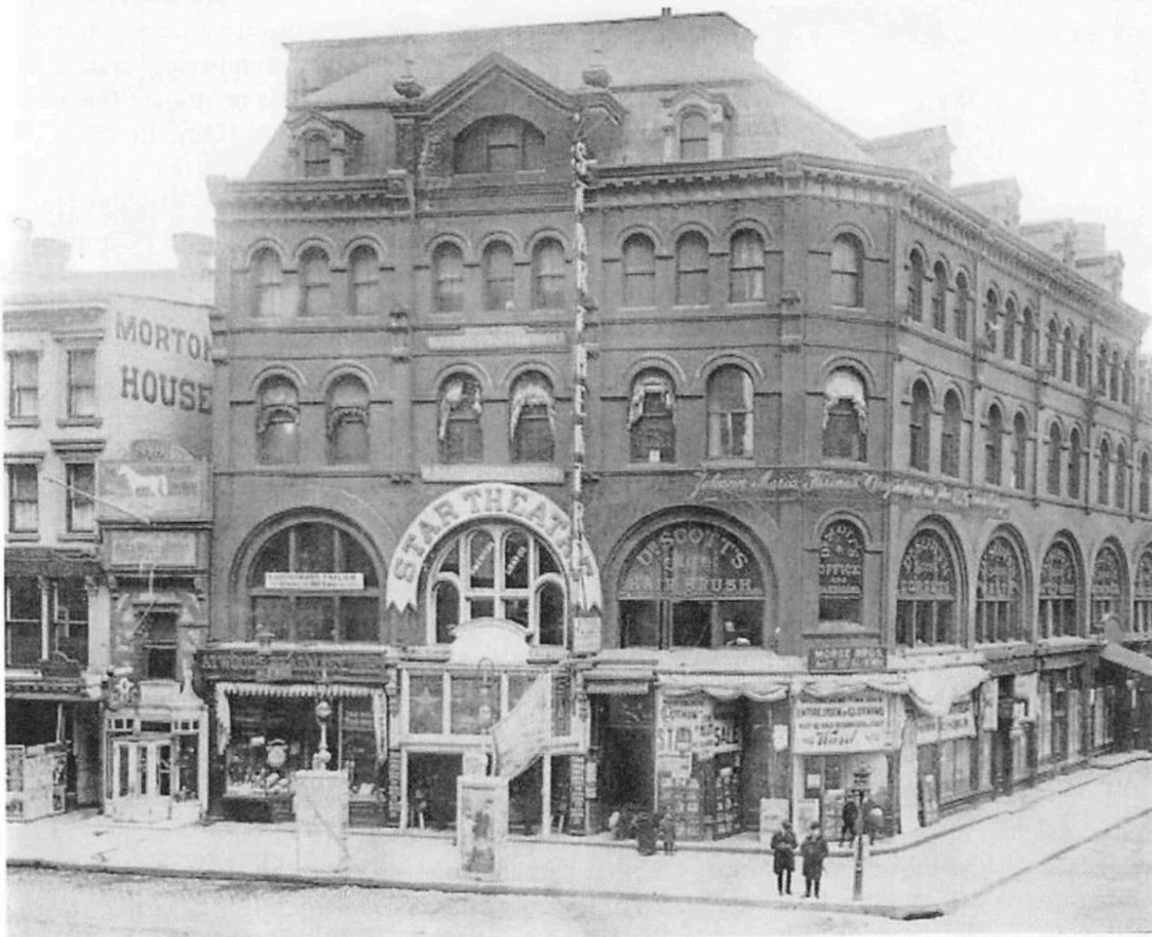
Quotes drawn from this page: 77



June 8, 1861, and was mustered in as the 83rd New York for the duration of the war, seeing action at Bull Run, South Mountain, Antietam, Fredericksburg, Chancellorsville, Gettysburg, the Wilderness, Spotsylvania, and Cold Harbor. The plaque notes: "They returned home June 11, 1864, with 17 officers and 78 enlisted men after having gone through 24 battles." In between, 379 men were killed and the rest wounded. This was typical of the efforts and sacrifices made by New York volunteers during the war.

064. WALLACK'S THEATER

842-846 Broadway, on the northeast corner of East 13th Street



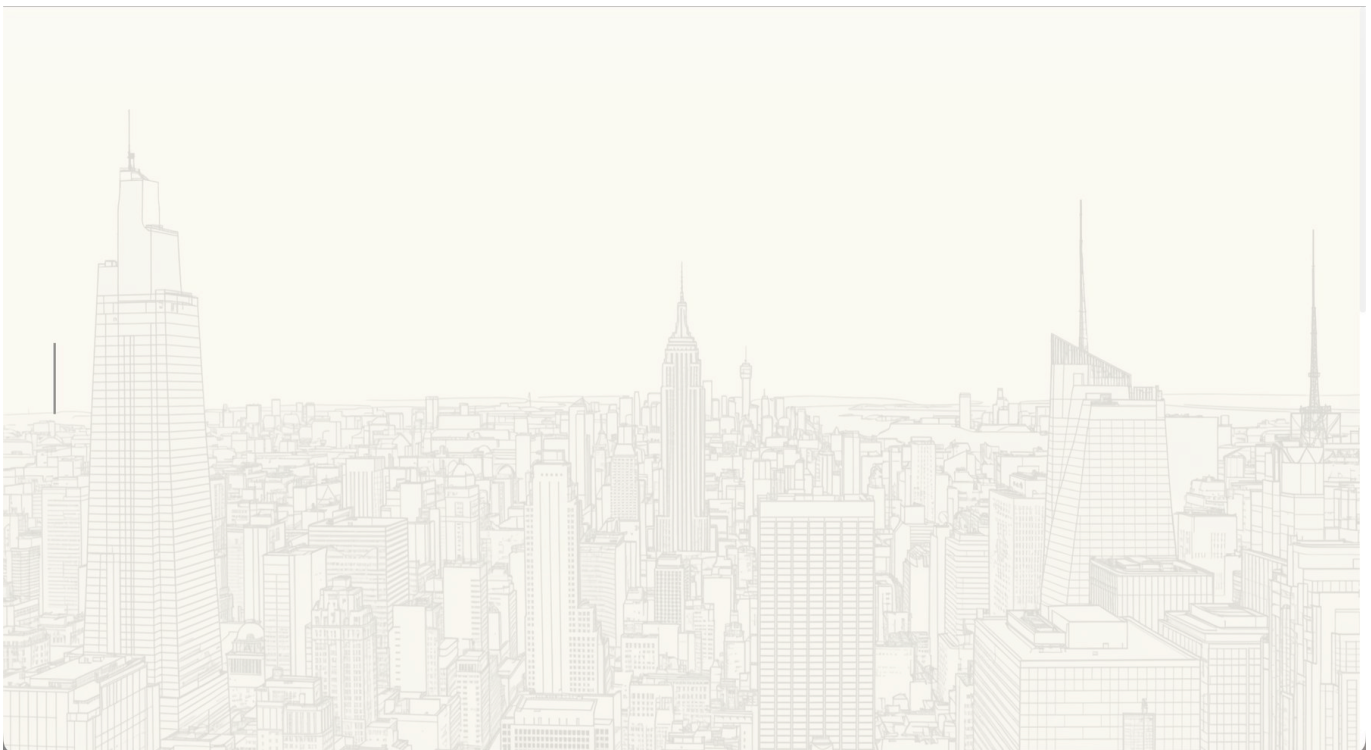
Wallack's Theater building in the later 1800s.

In September 1861, John Lester Wallack (1820–1888) opened the second Wallack's Theatre at Broadway and East 13th Street, now replaced by a modern multiplex cinema. As New York's affluent citizens moved further north, so did the stores and entertainment facilities that catered to them. Wallack's new theater was designed to be the most elegant in the city, with ticket prices

them. Wallack's new theater was designed to be the most elegant in the city, with ticket prices ranging from a quarter to as much as several dollars for the best seats. Wallack's inaugural play here was a three-act drama entitled *The New President*. Of particular Civil War interest was the New York debut of actor John Wilkes Booth as *Richard III*. Booth came from a family of actors,

Gabrielan, *Along Broadway*, 2007, p. 56

Quotes drawn from this page: 79 97





UNION SQUARE IN 1850

Avenues near
Union Park,
as it was
called, lined
with trees.
Reservoir on
13th Street,
near Fourth
Avenue.
Four-horse
car on Fourth
Avenue.
Lithograph
by J. Bornet.
One of *Vues
of New York*
issued by H.
Hoff. From
proof in Eno
Collection,
The New
York Public
Library.

Union Square, earlier Union Park, was formed at the juncture of Bloomingdale and Bowery Roads. The once hilly terrain was graded by 1834 and opened to the public by 1839 when it was designed for urbane dwelling in a city "moving uptown." D. Willis James presented the fountain by Donndorf where the supply of public water from the Croton Reservoir was celebrated on October 14, 1842.



The card depicts the January 2, 1902, blaze that damaged the stores and basement but spared the theater. Morton House, originated around 1850 as Union Place Hotel, expanded several times and was named for the Morton Brothers, operators from 1868 to the 1880s. It was demolished around 1926. The Star was known as Wallack's when the area burned and 1902.

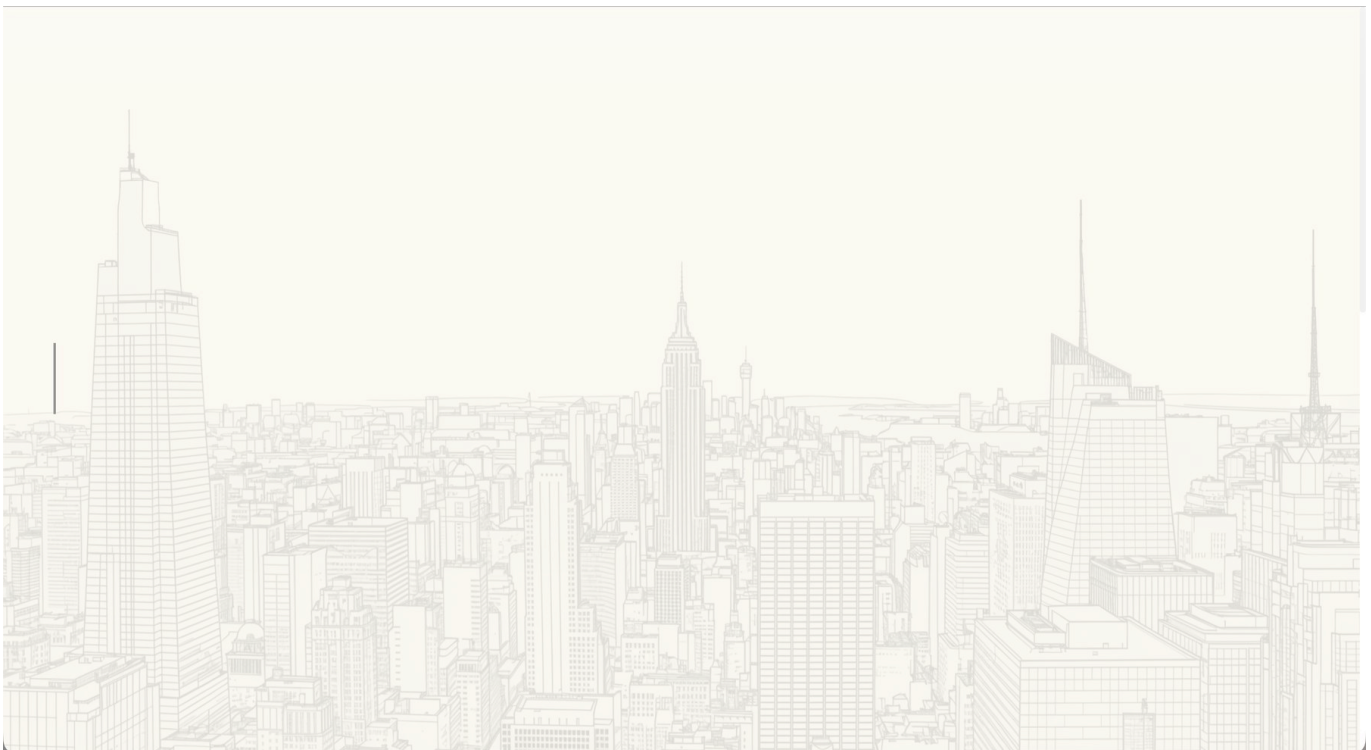
around 1920. The star was known as Warner's when the area, pictured on the 10th Street block, was the theater district.

565.2

56

Jenkins, *The Greatest Street in the World*, 1911, p. 222

Quotes drawn from this page: 93



farm, extending from the Bowery westward between the present Fourteenth and Sixteenth streets, to John Smith, from whose executors the farm passed in 1788 to Henry Spingler, a shop-keeper of New York, for nine hundred and fifty pounds. Spingler's farmhouse stood within the limits of Union Square. Other farms as far as Twenty-third Street on the west side belonged to Thomas Burling, John Cowman, Isaac Clason, Sir Peter Warren, Isaac Varian, and Christian Milderberger. On the east side, were the two farms of Cornelius Williams and John Watts. At the corner of the present Seventeenth Street and the Bloomingdale Road was a square acre of ground belonging to the Manhattan Bank, acquired so it is supposed, as a sort of refuge for conducting business in case of being driven from the city by the yellow fever.

850.1 81.1

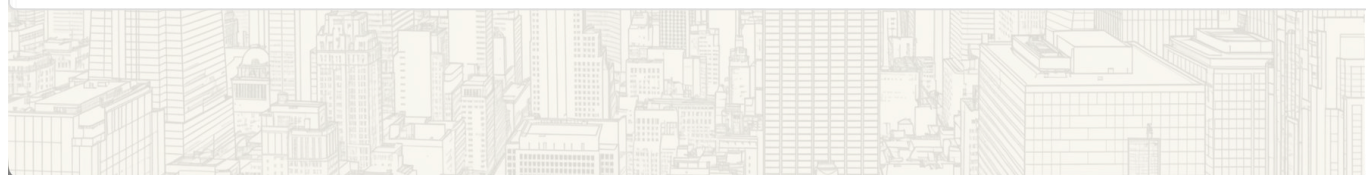
846.2

The hotel known as the Spingler House stood for many years on the west side of the square on the site now occupied by the Spingler building; on the south side, near University Place, was a fashionable restaurant called the *Maison Dorée*; on the southeast corner of Broadway and Fourteenth Street is the Hotel Churchill, formerly the Morton House, and originally the Union Place Hotel, established in 1850.

565.2

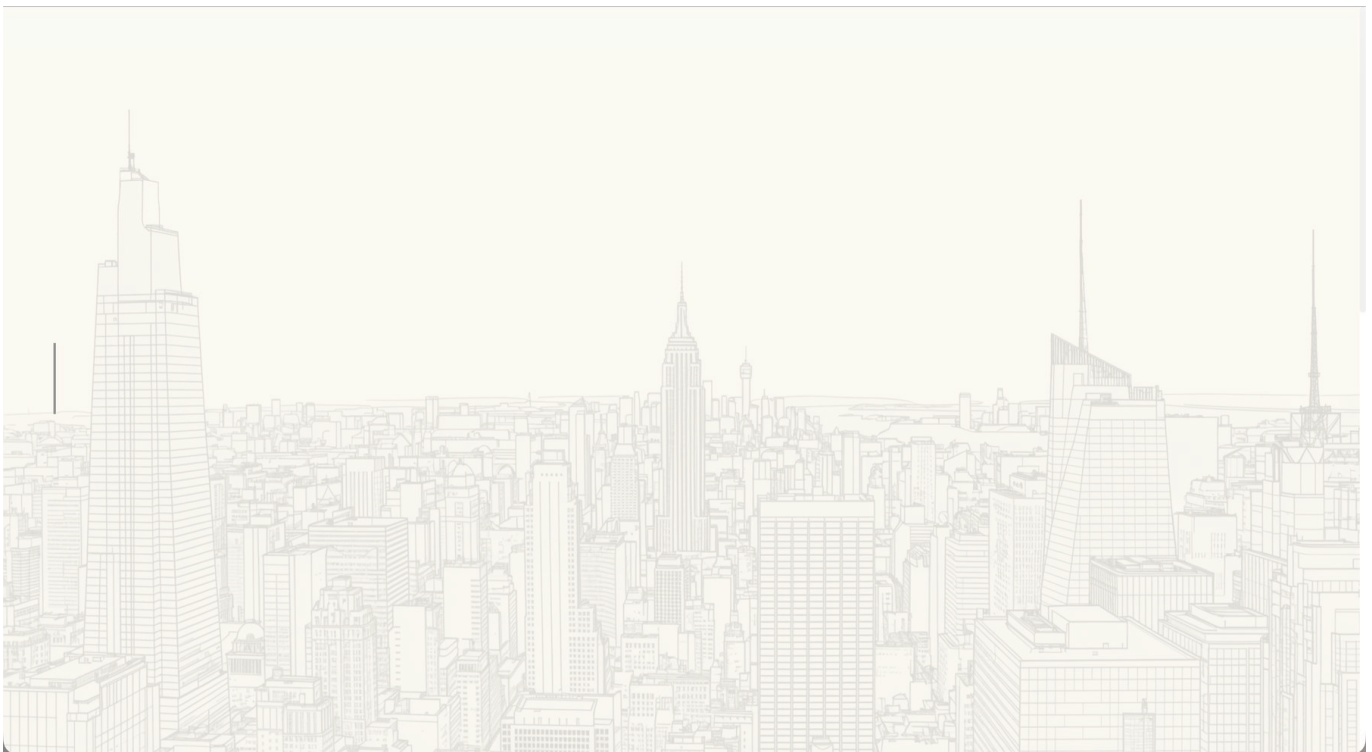
The section surrounding Union Square for several blocks was for a great many years the ultra-fashionable part of the city. Among the prominent shops which occupied the west side of the square was the great jewelry house of Tiffany & Co., which moved here from Broadway and Broome Street in 1870, occupying a site upon which formerly had stood the Spingler Institute. Tiffany remained at the southwest corner of Fifteenth Street until 1905, when the business was moved to Fifth Avenue and Thirty-seventh Street, as the highest class of trade was moving to that avenue; Schirmer, and Ditson &

842



Stokes, *The Iconography of Manhattan Island Volume Three*, 1918, p. 704

Quotes drawn from this page: 94



at 156 Fourth Avenue. Between the hotel and the corner house stood the livery stable of Paul D. Burbank.

870.1

On the south-east corner of 15th Street and Fourth Avenue was the school of Madam H. D. Chegaray. In the block to the north were the residences of John Griswold, S. B. Ruggles, G. W. Coster, William Kent, John Hicks, Richard Tighe, and, on the corner of 16th Street, J. Fisher Sheafe. The residence of Richard Tighe, still standing in 1896, is shown in a view in Pelletreau's *Early New York Houses*, where it is described as the "Last Dwelling on Union Square."

This entire block (as well as the double houses in which Madam Chegaray's school was maintained) was erected as a speculation by Samuel B. Ruggles, who had a thirty years' lease of the property from the Cornelius T. Williams estate. One of the conditions of the lease was that a ten-foot set-back should be left for court-yards. These courts show very plainly in the view.

Grace Church, erected in 1846 on Broadway and 10th Street, is a conspicuous feature; south-east of it appears the steeple of the 9th Street Collegiate Dutch Reformed Church, while St. Mark's can be seen to the east, surrounded by trees. 558

The reservoir, on the south side of 13th Street, east of Fourth Avenue, and the Washington Institute, to the left of it, are plainly seen. For a larger view of these two buildings, see Valentine's *Manual* for 1853, opposite p. 134.

545

PLATE 136

VIEW OF UNION PARK, NEW YORK, FROM THE HEAD OF BROADWAY

Lithograph.

16½ x 11¾

Date depicted: 1849.

Date issued: Copyright 1849.

Artist: Jas. Smillie.

Lithographers: Sarony & Major.

Publishers: Williams & Stevens.

Owner: I.N.P.S.

Other copies: N. Y. Public Library; N. Y. Hist. Society, etc.

Only known state. This view depicts the city looking north from Union Park, and forms a companion to the preceding plate.

The Spingler Institute and the Church of the Puritans are seen to the left. The latter site was occupied from 1870 to 1905 by Tiffany & Co., whose old building is still standing. The house on the north corner of 15th Street and Union Square was owned and occupied at this time by Anson G. Phelps, on a twenty-one years' lease from the Spingler Estate, which still (1917) owns the property. The three houses north of this were the residences, respectively, of Samuel L. Mitchell, David Lee, and Richard L. Schieffelin. The large house on the north-west corner of Broadway and 17th Street was that of Robert Goelet, while the one on the opposite corner, with the conservatory, was the residence of Henry Parrish. The Union League Club, organised in 1863, occupied the Parrish house from May 12, 1863, to April 1, 1868, when it moved to the Jerome house on Madison Avenue and 26th Street. Within a few years after the publication of this view, all of the vacant lots in the block on 17th Street north of Union Park had been built upon. A view of the park from the south-east, showing Broadway and the houses on 17th Street, was issued in coloured lithograph, in 1852, by Geib & Jackson; and a view of the north-west corner of 17th Street

840 BROADWAY

1899, by Robert Maynicke. [12 stories] This handsome white tower, with elegantly detailed architraves, has a chamfered corner and a two-story arcade.

13th STREET

W ROOSEVELT BUILDING, No. 839

1893, by Stephen Decatur Hatch. [9 stories] The complex and heavily ornamented façade is dominated by giant arched bays of tautly arranged windows, between three-story Roman-brick pilasters. The corner buttress is topped by a great copper knob.



Domestic Sewing Machine Building. NYHS.

UNION BUILDING, No. 849-53

1928-29, by Emery Roth. [23 stories] A stark buff-brick tower with a nervously articulated grid. Site of Domestic Sewing Machine Building, 1872, by Griffith Thomas; Cornelius Van Schaack Roosevelt house, ca. 1846.

E ROGERS, PEET BUILDING, No. 842

(Also known as the Village Voice offices). 1902, by Clinton & Russell. [8 stories] The red-brick façade is divided into bays topped by large segmental arches. There are copper dormers on the mansard roof. Site of Wallack's Theater (also known as the Germania Theater, Star), 1860-61, by Thomas R. Jackson, remodeled 1883 and 1889.

VACANT LOT, No. 850-60

Site of Morton House Hotel (also known as the Hotel Churchill, Union Place Hotel).

UNION SQUARE THEATER and MORTON HOUSE

Nothing remains on Broadway of the hotel or theater. But the auditorium house exists on the 14th Street midblock, as does a wing of the hotel, with pediment-framed windows.



Georgetown Plaza (left) and Astor Place Building, 1987.

House, a huge apartment tower that replaced the Stewart store, which burned in 1956 as it was being prepared for demolition. In later years, other fire-damaged stores were salvaged for residential purposes. McCreery's, which had become a shoe and handbag factory, burned in 1971. Instead of being scrapped, it was renovated as an apartment house. The W. & J. Sloane building burned in 1979. Its façades were saved to form a nineteenth-century veneer for a modern apartment building. Nothing could save the Broadway Central Hotel, however. In its final years, it straddled two worlds. It housed the six-theater Mercer Arts Center but was also "one of the worst 'welfare hotels,' a "cesspool of squalor and crime."⁴⁷ More than 300 people were living there in 1973 when the building collapsed, killing four.

Almost twenty years after the closing of Wanamaker's, Broadway got its "first major department store for the hip," as the *Village Voice* described the Unique Clothing Warehouse, south of Astor Place.⁴⁸ The *Voice* itself moved in 1980 to Thirteenth Street, where Rogers, Peet had once done business. Publishers settled again in the area in the 1970s and '80s, and bookstores like Shakespeare & Company and Untitled II opened. The Hebrew Union College-Jewish Institute of Religion, the Western Hemisphere's oldest and largest institution of Jewish higher education, moved to Fourth Street from West Sixty-eighth Street in 1979.⁴⁹

This revitalization attracted wide notice. "Things are changing on Lower Broadway faster than anyone had probably ever thought possible," the *Times* said in 1984, adding, a year later, that "it has become the momentary locus of hip."⁵⁰ Even as the street came ostentatiously and noisily back to life, however, one old quality endured that had been appreciatively described in 1876: "In the midst of the bustle of this babel of business, the observer will be surprised to discover even one spot where peace and quiet and solemnity reign supreme, and his eye will sparkle with delight as he distinguishes through the trees the graceful contour of Grace Church."⁵¹

James H. McCreery & Company Store (left), 810 Broadway (center), and the Remick (right), 1987.